

ELIOTTE'S THREE THE AGES DENNILLWORTHY LEIST
 ARTHUR A. LEVINE REEKS AN IMPRINT OF SCHEASTIC
 PRESS IN ASSOCIATION WITH WHIZZ HARD REEKS 1878 DRADLIN
 ALLY, LEEDEN PRAISE FOR ELIOTTE'S THREE THE AGES
 "DENNILLWORTHY LEIST'S PAINSTAKING RESEARCH HAS UNCOVERED A
 VERITABLE TREASURE TREVE HETHTERTHE LINDENHAY FACTS ABOUT THE
 SPIRIT OF WARLOCKS, A FASCINATING READ," -KATHILDA RAGSETH, ALTHIR,
 A HISTORY OF MAGIC "LEIST HAS PRODUCED A TERRIFICALLY
 ENHANCABLE REEKS; ELIOTTE'S FANS ARE SURE TO FIND IT BOTH
 INSTRUCTIVE AND ENTERTAINING," -EDITH LEICH KREHMSTICK "THE
 DEFINITIVE WORK ON THE ORIGINS AND HISTORY OF ELIOTTE'S, HIGHLY
 RECOMMENDED," -KRWLIS SCRINGERHAR, ALTHIR, THE BEATERS' BIBLE
 "MR. LEIST SETS A LOT OF PREMISE. IF HE KEEPS UP THE GOOD WORK,
 HE MAY WELL FIND HIMSELF SHARING A PRETHETHEM WITH MR HENR OF
 THESE DAYS," -GILBERTH LEEDEHART, ALTHIR, MAGICAL MR "BET WELL
 ANYTHING IT'LL BE A BEST-SELLER, CHEN, IGET WELL," -LUDWIK RAGMAN,
 ENGLAND AND WIMBURN WASTS BEATER "I'VE READ WHERE," -RITA
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ALTHOUGH KENNILWORTHY WHISP IS A RENOWNED HULDDITCH
EXPERT (AND, HE SAYS, FANATIC), HE IS THE AUTHOR OF MANY
HULDDITCH-RELATED WORKS, INCLUDING THE WANDER OF WIGTHIN
WANDERERS, HE FLEW LIKE A MADMAN (A KITHGRAPH OF "DANGERHUS"
DAI BILWELLYN) AND BEATING THE BILDBERS - A STUDY OF DEFENSIVE
STRATEGIES IN HULDDITCH. KENNILWORTHY WHISP DIVIDES HIS TIME
BETWEEN HIS HOME IN NOTTINGHAMSHIRE AND "WHEREVER WIGTHIN
WANDERERS ARE PLAYING THIS WEEK." HIS Hobbies INCLUDE
BACKCAMPING, VEGETARIAN COOKERY, AND COLLECTING VINTAGE
BROOMSTICKS. CONTENTS FORTHWARD VIT 1. THE EVOLUTION OF THE FLYING
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REFEREES 12. HULDDITCH TEAMS OF BRITAIN AND IRELAND 13. THE
SPREAD OF HULDDITCH WORLDWIDE 14. THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE
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THE WHEELS OF THE AGES IS ONE OF THE MOST POPULAR TITLES IN
THE HOGWARTS SCHOOL LIBRARY. MADAM PINCE, HER LIBRARIAN, TELLS ME
THAT IT IS "PAWED ABOUT, DRIPPED ON, AND GENERALLY MALTREATED"
NEARLY EVERY DAY - A HIGH COMPLIMENT FOR ANY BOOK. ANYONE WHO
PLAYS OR WATCHES HULDDITCH REGULARLY WILL RELISH MR. WHISP'S BOOK,
AS SHE THEMSELF IS INTERESTED IN WIDER WIZARDING HISTORY. AS WE
HAVE DEVELOPED THE GAME OF HULDDITCH, SHE IT HAS DEVELOPED US;
HULDDITCH UNITES WITCHES AND WIZARDS FROM ALL WALKS OF LIFE,
BRINGING US TOGETHER THE SHARE MOMENTS OF EXHILARATION, TRIUMPH,
AND (FOR THEMSELF WHO SLIPPER THE CHILDRY CANDIDENS) DESPAIR. IT WAS
WITH SOME DIFFICULTY, I MUST ADD, THAT I PERSUADED MADAM PINCE THE
PART WITH ONE OF HER BOOKS SHE THAT IT MIGHT BE LOANED FOR WIDER
CIRCULATION. INDEED, WHEN I TOLD HER IT WAS THE BE MADE AVAILABLE THE
MUGGLES, SHE WAS RENDERED TEMPORARILY SPEECHLESS, AND NEITHER
MOVED NOR BLINKED FOR SEVERAL MINUTES. WHEN SHE CAME TO HERSELF
SHE WAS THOUGHTFUL ENOUGH TO ASK WHETHER I HAD TAKEN LEAVE OF
MY SENSES. I WAS PLEASED TO REASSURE HER AND THAT POINT AND WENT
ON TO EXPLAIN WHY I HAD TAKEN THIS UNPRECEDENTED DECISION.
MUGGLE READERS WILL NEED NO INTRODUCTION TO THE WORK OF CHEMIE
RELIEF L. D., WHICH, FLUENTLY ENOUGH, HAS NOTHING TO DO WITH THE
AMERICAN ORGANIZATION OF THE SAME NAME! SHE I NOW REPEAT MY

EXPLANATION THE MADAM PINE FOR THE BENEFIT OF WITCHES AND WIZARDS WHO HAVE PURCHASED THIS BOOK. CHEMIE RELIEF L.J. D. USES LAUGHTER THE FIGHT POVERTY, INJUSTICE, AND DISASTER. WIDESPREAD AMUSEMENT IS CONVERTED INTO LARGE QUANTITIES OF MONEY (OVER 250 MILLION DOLLARS SINCE THEY STARTED IN 1785 - WHICH IS THE EQUIVALENT OF OVER 1.74 MILLION POUNDS OR THIRTY-FOUR MILLION GALLONS). EVERYONE INVOLVED IN GETTING THIS BOOK THE POOL, FROM THE AUTHOR THE PUBLISHER THE PAPER SUPPLIERS, PRINTERS, BINDERS, AND BOOKSELLERS, CONTRIBUTED THEIR TIME, ENERGY, AND MATERIALS FREE OF AT A REDUCED COST, MAKING IT POSSIBLE FOR PROCEEDS FROM THE SALE OF THIS VII BOOK THE GO TO A FUND SET UP IN HARRY POTTER'S NAME BY CHEMIE RELIEF L.J. D. AND I. D. RHEMING. THIS FUND WAS DESIGNED SPECIFICALLY TO HELP CHILDREN IN NEED THROUGHOUT THE WORLD. BY BUYING THIS BOOK - AND I WOULD ADVISE YOU TO BUY IT, BECAUSE IF YOU READ IT THEN BEING WITHOUT HANDING OVER MONEY YOU WILL FIND YOURSELF THE HEIR OF A THIEF'S CURSE - YOU THEN WILL BE CONTRIBUTING TO THIS MAGICAL MISSION. I WOULD BE DECEIVING MY READERS IF I SAID THAT THIS EXPLANATION MADE MADAM PINE HAPPY ABOUT HANDING OVER A LIBRARY BOOK THE MUGGLES. SHE SUGGESTED SEVERAL ALTERNATIVES, SUCH AS TELLING THE PEOPLE FROM CHEMIE RELIEF L.J. D. THAT THE LIBRARY HAD TURNED DOWN, OR SIMPLY PRETENDING THAT I HAD DROPPED DEAD WITHOUT LEAVING INSTRUCTIONS. WHEN I TOLD HER THAT EVEN WHILE I PREFERRED MY ORIGINAL PLAN, SHE RELUCTANTLY AGREED TO HAND OVER THE BOOK, THOUGH AT THE POINT WHEN IT CAME TO LET GO OF IT, HER NERVE FAILED HER AND I WAS FORCED TO PRIZE HER FINGERS INDIVIDUALLY FROM THE SPINE. OF THOUGH I HAVE REMOVED THE USUAL LIBRARY BOOK SPELLS FROM THIS VOLUME, I CANNOT PROMISE THAT EVERY TRACE HAS GONE. MADAM PINE HAS BEEN KNOWN TO ADD USUAL INDEXES TO THE BOOKS IN HER CARE. I MYSELF BEHOLD ASSENTMINDFULLY IN A COPY OF THEORIES TRANSLUCENTIAL TRANSLUCENTIAL LAST YEAR AND NEXT MOMENT FEELING THE BOOK BEATING ME FIRMLY ABOUT THE HEAD. PLEASE BE CAREFUL WHEN YOU TREAT THIS BOOK. DO NOT RIP OUT THE PAGES. DO NOT DROP IT IN THE BATH. I CANNOT PROMISE THAT MADAM PINE WILL NOT SWEEP DOWN ON YOU, WHEREVER YOU ARE, AND DEMAND A HEAVY FINE. ALL THAT REMAINS IS FOR ME TO THANK YOU FOR SLIPPERING CHEMIE RELIEF L.J. D. AND THE REG MUGGLES NOT TO TRY PLAYING HARRY POTTER AT HOME; IT IS, OF COURSE, AN ENTIRELY FICTIONAL SPORT AND NOBODY REALLY PLAYS IT. MAY I ALSO

TAKE THIS OPPORTUNITY THE WISE PLDDBLEMER UNITE THE REST OF LUCK
NEXT SEASON. ADONIA CHAPTER ENR THE EVOLUTION OF THE FLYING
BROOMSTICK IS SPELL YET DEvised ENABLES WIZARDS THE FLY UNAIDED IN
DEILMAN FIRM. THESE FEW ANIMAGI WEEN TRANSFORM INTO WINGED
CREATURES MAY ENHED FLIGHT, BUT THEY ARE A RARITY. THE WITCH HER
WIZARD WEEN FINDS HIM- HER HERSELF TRANSFIGURED INTO A BAT MAY TAKE
THE THE AIR, BUT, HAVING A BAT'S BRAIN, THEY ARE SURE THE FORGET WHERE
THEY WANT THE GO THE MOMENT THEY TAKE FLIGHT. LEVITATION IS
COMMONPLACE, BUT ELIJAH ANCESTERS WERE NOT CONTENT WITH HANGING
FIVE FEET FROM THE GROUND. THEY WANTED MORE. THEY WANTED THE FLY
LIKE BIRDS, BUT WITHOUT THE INCONVENIENCE OF GROWING FEATHERS. WE
ARE SO ACCUSTOMED THESE DAYS TO THE FACT THAT EVERY WIZARDING
FAMILIES IN BRITAIN HEDS AT LEAST ONE FLYING BROOMSTICK THAT WE
RARELY STOP TO ASK OURSELVES WHY. WHY SHOULD THE FLYING BROOM
HAVE BECOME THE ONE MEANS LEGALLY ALLOWED AS A MEANS OF WIZARDING
TRANSPORT? WHY DID WE IN THE WEST NOT ADOPT THE CARPET SO
RELIED ON OUR EASTERN BROTHERS? WHY DIDN'T WE CHOOSE THE PRACTICE
FLYING BARRELS, FLYING ARMCHAIRS, FLYING BATHTUBS - WHY BROOMS?
SHOULD ENOUGH TO SEE THAT THEIR MUGGLE NEIGHBOURS WOULD SEE
THE EXHIBIT THEIR POWERS IF THEY KNEW THEIR FULL EXTENT, WITCHES
AND WIZARDS KEPT THEMSELVES TO THEMSELVES LONG BEFORE THE
INTERNATIONAL STATUTE OF WIZARDING SECRECY CAME INTO EFFECT. IF
THEY WERE TO KEEP A MEANS OF FLIGHT IN THEIR HOMES, IT WOULD
NECESSARILY BE SOMETHING DISCREET, SOMETHING EASY TO HIDE. THE
BROOMSTICK WAS IDEAL FOR THIS PURPOSE; IT REQUIRED NO
EXPLANATION, NO EXCUSE IF SEEN BY MUGGLES, IT WAS EASILY PORTABLE
AND INEXPENSIVE. NEVERTHELESS, THE FIRST BROOMS KNOWN FOR
FLYING PURPOSES HAD THEIR DRAWBACKS. RECORDS SHOW THAT WITCHES
AND WIZARDS IN EUROPE WERE USING FLYING BROOMSTICKS AS EARLY AS
AD. 900. A GERMAN ILLUMINATED MANUSCRIPT OF THIS PERIOD SHOWS
THREE WARLOCKS DISMOUNTING FROM THEIR BROOMS WITH LOOKS OF
EXHILISTE DISCOMFORT ON THEIR FACES. ELTHIRIE LEECH-IRIN, A SCOTTISH
WIZARD WRITING IN 1100, SPEAKS OF THE "SPINTERFILLED BLITCHES AND
BLINGING PILES" HE SUFFERED AFTER A SHORT BROOM RIDE FROM MENTRESS
THE ARKATH. A MEDIEVAL BROOMSTICK ON DISPLAY IN THE MUSEUM OF
HISTORY IN LONDON GIVES US AN INSIGHT INTO LEECH-IRIN'S
DISCOMFORT (SEE FIG. A). A THICK BROOMY HANDLE OF UNYARNISHED ASH,
WITH HAZEL TWIGS BEHIND CRIBELY THE ONE END, IT IS NEITHER

COMFORTABLE AND AERODYNAMIC. THE CHAIRS PLACED UPON IT ARE SIMILARLY BASIC: IT WILL ONLY MOVE FORWARDS AT ONE SPEED; IT WILL GO UP, DOWN, AND STOP. AS WIZARDING FAMILIES IN THESE DAYS MADE THEIR OWN CHAIRS, THERE WAS ENORMOUS VARIATION IN THE SPEED, COMFORT, AND HANDLING OF THE TRANSPORT AVAILABLE TO THEM. BY THE TWELFTH CENTURY, HOWEVER, WIZARDS HAD LEARNED THE BARTER SERVICES, SO THAT A SKILLED MAKER OF CHAIRS COULD EXCHANGE THEM FOR THE FURNITURE HIS NEIGHBOR MIGHT MAKE BETTER THAN HIMSELF. SINCE CHAIRS BECAME MORE COMFORTABLE, THEY WERE USED FOR PLEASURE RATHER THAN MERELY USED AS A MEANS OF GETTING FROM POINT A TO POINT B. FIG. 1 CHAPTER TWO ANCIENT CHAIR GAMES CHAIR SPORTS EMERGED ALMOST AS SOON AS CHAIRS WERE SUFFICIENTLY ADVANCED TO ALLOW FLIERS TO TURN CORNERS AND VARY THEIR SPEED AND HEIGHT. EARLY WIZARDING WRITINGS AND PAINTINGS GIVE US SOME IDEA OF THE GAMES OUR ANCESTERS PLAYED. SOME OF THESE NO LONGER EXIST; OTHERS HAVE SURVIVED OR EVOLVED INTO THE SPORTS WE KNOW TODAY. THE CELEBRATED ANNUAL CHAIR RACE OF SWEDEN DATES FROM THE TENTH CENTURY. FLIERS RACE FROM ÖHPARKER TO ÖRIEPLING, A DISTANCE OF SLIGHTLY OVER THREE HUNDRED MILES. THE CHAIRS RUN STRAIGHT THROUGH A DRAGON RESERVATION, AND THE VAST SILVER TROPHY IS SHAPED LIKE A SWEDISH SMITHS. NEARLY THIS IS AN INTERNATIONAL EVENT AND WIZARDS OF ALL NATIONALITIES CONGREGATE AT ÖHPARKER TO CHEER THE STARTERS, THEN APPROPRIATE TO ÖRIEPLING TO CONGRATULATE THE SURVIVORS. THE FAMOUS PAINTING ÖNTHER DER ÖRLAUF TIGER IST DER ÖWINNER ("ÖNTER THE VIBRANT IS THE WINNER"), DATED 1100, SHOWS THE ANCIENT GERMAN GAME OF STICK-THROW. A TWENTY-FOUR-FOOT PEEK WAS THROWN WITH AN INFLATED DRAGON BLADDER. ONE PLAYER AND A CHAIRS HAD THE JOB OF PROTECTING THIS BLADDER. THE BLADDER-GUARDIAN WAS TIED TO THE PEEK BY A ROPE AROUND HIS OR HER WAIST, SO THAT HE OR SHE COULD NOT GO FURTHER THAN TEN FEET AWAY FROM IT. THE REST OF THE PLAYERS WOULD TAKE IT IN TURNS TO GO AT THE BLADDER AND ATTEMPT TO PUNCTURE IT WITH THE SPECIALLY SHARPENED ENDS OF THEIR CHAIRS. THE BLADDER-GUARDIAN WAS ALLOWED TO USE HIS OR HER WAND TO REPEL THESE ATTACKS. THE GAME ENDED WHEN THE BLADDER WAS SUCCESSFULLY PUNCTURED, OR THE BLADDER-GUARDIAN HAD EITHER SUCCEEDED IN FIXING ALL OPPONENTS OUT OF THE RUNNING OR COLLAPSED FROM EXHAUSTION. STICK-THROW DIED OUT IN THE FIFTEENTH

CENTURY, IN IRELAND THE GAME OF AINGINGIN FLOURISHED, THE SUBJECT OF MANY AN IRISH BALLAD THE LEGENDARY WIZARD FINGAL THE FEARLESS IS ALLEGED TO HAVE BEEN AN AINGINGIN CHAMPION. ONE BY ONE THE PLAYERS WOULD TAKE THE DEEM, OR BALL (ACTUALLY THE GALLEBLADDER OF A CHAT), AND SPEED THROUGH A SERIES OF TURNING BARRELS SET HIGH IN THE AIR ON STILTS. THE DEEM WAS THEN THROWN THROUGH THE FINAL BARREL. THE PLAYER WHO SUCCEEDED IN GETTING THE DEEM THROUGH THE LAST BARREL IN THE FASTEST TIME, WITHOUT HAVING CALLED FIRE ON THE WAY, WAS THE WINNER. SCOTLAND WAS THE BIRTHPLACE OF WHAT IS PROBABLY THE MOST DANGEROUS OF ALL GAMES - CREAMHE-LEANN. THE GAME FEATURES IN A TRAGIC EARLY POEM OF THE ELEVENTH CENTURY, THE FIRST VERSE OF WHICH SAYS, IN TRANSLATION: THE PLAYERS ASSEMBLED, TWELVE FINE, HEARTY MEN, THEY STRAPPED ON THEIR CALIBRENS, STEADY PULSED THE PLY, AT THE SIGNAL AFTER WHICH THEY WERE SWIFTLY AIRBORNE BUT TEN OF THEIR NUMBER WERE FATED TO DIE. CREAMHE-LEANN PLAYERS EACH WORE A CALIBREN STRAPPED TO THE HEAD, AT THE SIGNAL OF THE HORN OR DRUM, UP TO A HUNDRED CHARGED ROCKS AND BULLETS THAT HAD BEEN HURVING A HUNDRED FEET ABOVE THE GROUND BEGAN TO FALL TOWARDS THE EARTH. THE CREAMHE-LEANN PLAYERS THEMSELVES WERE TRYING TO CATCH AS MANY ROCKS AS POSSIBLE IN THEIR CALIBRENS. CONSIDERED BY MANY SCOTTISH WIZARDS TO BE THE SUPREME TEST OF MANLINESS AND COURAGE, CREAMHE-LEANN ENJOYED CONSIDERABLE POPULARITY IN THE MIDDLE AGES, & DESPITE THE HUGE NUMBER OF FATALITIES THAT RESULTED FROM IT. THE GAME WAS MADE ILLEGAL IN 1782, AND THOUGH MAGNUS "DENT-HEAD" MACDONALD SPARE-HEADED A CAMPAIGN FOR ITS REINTRODUCTION IN THE 1880S, THE MINISTRY OF MAGIC REFUSED THE LIST THE KING. SKINTLEMP WAS POPULAR IN DEVON, ENGLAND. THIS WAS A CRUDE FORM OF HURLING, THE SIMPLE AIM BEING TO DOWN AS MANY OTHER PLAYERS AS POSSIBLE WITH THEIR KNEES. THE LAST PERSON REMAINING ON THEIR KNEES WINNING. A SWIVENEDGE BEGAN IN DERBYSHIRE. LIKE STICKSTICK, THIS INVOLVED AN INFLATED BLADDER, USUALLY PIG'S. PLAYERS SAT BACKWARDS ON THEIR KNEES AND BATTED THE BLADDER BACKWARDS AND FORWARDS ACROSS A HEDGE WITH THE FLAT ENDS OF THEIR KNEES. THE FIRST PERSON TO MISS GAVE THEIR OPPONENT A POINT. FIRST TO REACH FIFTY POINTS WAS THE WINNER. SWIVENEDGE IS STILL PLAYED IN ENGLAND, THOUGH IT HAS NEVER ACHIEVED MUCH WIDESPREAD POPULARITY. SKINTLEMP SURVIVES ONLY AS A CHILDREN'S GAME. AT HILPERDITCH

MARSH, HOWEVER, A GAME HAD BEEN CREATED THAT WOULD ONE DAY
BECOME THE MOST POPULAR IN THE WIZARDING WORLD. & CHAPTER THREE
THE GAME FROM HUNTERDITCH MARSH & HOW ELIA KNOWLEDGE OF THE
RULE BEGINNINGS OF HUNTERDITCH THE THE WRITINGS OF THE WITCH
GERTIE REDDLE, WHO LIVED IN THE EDGE OF HUNTERDITCH MARSH IN THE
ELEVENTH CENTURY, FORTUNATELY FOR US, SHE KEPT A DIARY, NOW IN THE
MUSEUM OF HUNTERDITCH IN LONDON. THE EXCERPTS BELOW HAVE BEEN
TRANSLATED FROM THE BADLY SPELLED Saxon OF THE ORIGINAL. TUESDAY,
FIFT, THAT LEFT FROM ACROSS THE MARSH HAVE BEEN AT IT AGAIN,
PLAYING A STUPID GAME IN THEIR BROOMSTICKS. A BIG LEATHER BALL
LANDED IN MY CARRIAGES. I HEARD THE MAN WHO CAME FOR IT. I'D LIKE TO
SEE HIM FLY WITH HIS BONES IN BACK THE FRONT, THE GREAT HAIRY ONE.
TUESDAY, NET, WAS HIT IN THE MARSH PICKING NETTLES. BROOMSTICK
IDITS PLAYING AGAIN. WATCHED FOR A BIT FROM BEHIND A REED. THEY'VE
GOT A NEW BALL. THROWING IT THE EACH OTHER AND TRYING THE STICK IT
IN TREES AT EITHER END OF THE MARSH. POINTLESS LIKE. TUESDAY,
WINDY. EVENING CAME FOR NETTLE TEA, THEN INVITED ME OUT FOR A
TREAT. ENDED UP WATCHING THESE NUMSKULLS & PLAYING THEIR GAME
IN THE MARSH. THAT BIG SCOTTISH WARRIOR FROM UP THE HILL WAS
THERE. NOW THEY'VE GOT TWO BIG, HEAVY REEDS FLYING AROUND TRYING
TO KNOCK THEM ALL OFF THEIR BROOMS. UNFORTUNATELY DIDN'T HAPPEN
WHILE I WAS WATCHING. EVENING TOLD ME SHE OFTEN PLAYED HERSELF.
WENT HOME IN DISGUST. THESE EXTRACTS REVEAL MUCH MORE THAN
GERTIE REDDLE COULD HAVE GUESSED, ELITE APART FROM THE FACT THAT
SHE ONLY KNEW THE NAME OF ONE OF THE DAYS OF THE WEEK. FIRSTLY, THE
BALL THAT LANDED IN HER CARRIAGE PATCH WAS MADE OF LEATHER, AS IS THE
MODERN BLADDER - NATURALLY, THE INFLATED BLADDER USED IN OTHER
BROOM GAMES OF THE PERIOD WOULD BE DIFFICULT TO THROW ACCURATELY,
PARTICULARLY IN WINDY CONDITIONS. SECONDLY, GERTIE TELLS US THAT
THE MEN WERE "TRYING THE STICK IT IN TREES AT EITHER END OF THE
MARSH" - APPARENTLY AN EARLY FORM OF CHAL-SEERING. THIRDLY, SHE
GIVES US A GLIMPSE OF THE FLYINGMEN OF BLUDGERS. IT IS IMMENSELY
INTERESTING THAT THERE WAS A "BIG SCOTTISH WARRIOR" PRESENT, COULD
HE HAVE BEEN A CREATH-KEARN PLAYER? WAS IT HIS IDEA TO KNOCK
HEAVY REEDS THE THEM DANGEROUSLY AROUND THE PITCH, INSPIRED BY
THE REEDERS USED IN HIS NATIVE GAME? WE FIND NO FURTHER MENTION
OF THE SPORT PLAYED IN HUNTERDITCH MARSH UNTIL A CENTURY LATER,
WHEN THE WIZARD GREGORY BROWN TOOK UP HIS PENCIL TO WRITE THE

HIS & IN NORWEGIAN HELSIN HILAP, KNOWN LIVED IN YORKSHIRE, WHICH DEMONSTRATES THE SPREAD OF THE SPORT THROUGHOUT BRITAIN THE HUNDRED YEARS AFTER CERTIE KEDDLE FIRST WITNESSED IT. KNOWN'S LETTER IS DEPOSITED IN THE ARCHIVES OF THE NORWEGIAN MINISTRY OF MAGIC. DEAR HILAP, HELN ARE HELN? I AM WELL, THOUGH GUNKILDA HAS GOTT A THING OF DRAGON FEEL. WE ENJOYED A SPIRITED GAME OF KLIDDITCH LAST SATURDAY NIGHT, THOUGH PHEER GUNKILDA WAS NOT UP THE PLAYING CATCHER, AND WE HAD THE LICE RADLIF THE BLACKSMITH INSTEAD. THE TEAM FROM ILLEY PLAYED WELL THOUGH WAS NOT MATCH FEELIS, FOR WE HAD BEEN PRACTISING HARD ALL MONTH AND SCORED FORTY-TWO TIMES. RADLIF GOTT A BLENDER IN THE HEAD BECAUSE HE LUGGA WASN'T HELIX ENOUGH WITH HIS CLUB. THE NEW SCORING BARRELS WORKED WELL. THREE AT EACH END AND STILTS, PHEER FROM THE INN GAVE US THEM. SHE LET US HAVE FREE MEAD ALL NIGHT BECAUSE WE WERE AS WELL. GUNKILDA WAS A BIT ANGRY I GOTT BACK SO LATE. I HAD THE BLIX A COUPLE OF NASTY INJURIES BUT I'VE GOTT MY FINGERS BACK NOW. I'M SENDING THIS WITH THE BEST HELN I'VE GOTT, HOPE EE MAKES IT. HELN HELSIN, GUNWIN HERE WE SEE HELN FAR THE GAME HAS PROGRESSED IN A CENTURY. GUNWIN'S WIFE WAS THE HAVE PLAYED "CATCHER" - PROBABLY THE OLD TERM FOR CHASER. THE "BLENDER" (UNDELETEDLY A BLENDER) THAT HIT RADLIF THE BLACKSMITH SHOULD HAVE BEEN PENDED OFF BY LUGGA, WHO WAS HEVILISLY PLAYING BEATER, AS HE WAS CARRYING A CLUB. THE GOALS ARE NOT LONGER TREES, BUT BARRELS AND STILTS. ONE CRUCIAL ELEMENT IN THE GAME WAS STILL MISSING, HOWEVER: THE CHILDEN SNITCH. THE ADDITION OF THE FOURTH KLIDDITCH BALL DID NOT OCCUR UNTIL THE MIDDLE OF THE THIRTEENTH CENTURY AND IT CAME ABOUT IN A CURIOUS MANNER. CHAPTER HELN THE ARRIVAL OF THE CHILDEN SNITCH FROM THE EARLY 1100S. SNIDGET-HUNTING HAD BEEN POPULAR AMONG MANY WITCHES AND WIZARDS. THE CHILDEN SNIDGET (SEE FIG. 8) IS TODAY A PROTECTED SPECIES, BUT AT THAT TIME CHILDEN SNIDGETS WERE COMMON IN NORTHERN EUROPE, THOUGH DIFFICULT TO DETECT BY MUGGLES BECAUSE OF THEIR ABILITY AT HIDING AND THEIR VERY GREAT SPEED. THE DIMINUTIVE SIZE OF THE SNIDGET, COUPLED WITH ITS REMARKABLE AGILITY IN THE AIR AND TALENT AT AVOIDING PREDATORS, MERELY ADDED TO THE PRESTIGE OF WIZARDS WHO CAUGHT THEM. A TWELFTH-CENTURY TAPESTRY PRESERVED IN THE MUSEUM OF KLIDDITCH SHOWS A GREEN SETTING WITH THE CATCH A SNIDGET. IN THE FIRST PART OF THE TAPESTRY, SOME HUNTERS CARRY NETS, OTHERS USE WANDS, AND STILL OTHERS ATTEMPT TO CATCH THE

SNIDGET WITH THEIR BARE HANDS. THE 10 TAPESTRY REVEALS THE FACT THAT THE SNIDGET WAS OFTEN CRUSHED BY ITS CAPTHER. IN THE FINAL PARTHEN OF THE TAPESTRY WE SEE THE WIZARD WITH CALIGHT THE SNIDGET BEING PRESENTED WITH A BAG OF GHEB. SNIDGET-FLINTING WAS REPREHENSIBLE IN MANY WAYS. EVERY RIGHT-MINDED WIZARD MUST DEPLORE THE DESTRUCTION OF THESE PEACE-LOVING LITTLE BIRDS IN THE NAME OF SPIRIT. HOWEVER, SNIDGET-FLINTING, WHICH WAS USUALLY LINDRIFIC, & TAKEN IN BROAD DAYLIGHT, LED THE MORE MUGGLE ENTHUSIASTIC SIGHTINGS THAN ANY OTHER PURSUIT. THE WIZARDS' COUNCIL OF THE TIME, HOWEVER, WAS UNABLE TO CLARE THE SPIRIT'S POPULARITY - INDEED, IT APPEARS THAT THE COUNCIL ITSELF SAW LITTLE WRONG WITH IT, AS WE SHALL SEE. SNIDGET-FLINTING FINALLY CROSSED PATHS WITH FLIDDITCH IN 1289 AT A GAME ATTENDED BY THE CHIEF OF THE WIZARDS' 11 COUNCIL HIMSELF, BARBERUS BRACER. WE KNOW THIS BECAUSE OF THE EYEWITNESS ACCOUNT SENT BY MADAM MILDRED RABBITT OF HER SISTER PRUDENCE IN ABERDEEN (THIS LETTER IS ALSO ON DISPLAY IN THE MUSEUM OF FLIDDITCH). ACCORDING TO MADAM RABBITT, BRACER BRUGHT A CAGED SNIDGET TO THE MATCH AND TOLD THE ASSEMBLED PLAYERS THAT HE WOULD AWARD ONE HUNDRED AND FIFTY GALLEONS TO THE PLAYER WHO CALIGHT IT DURING THE COURSE OF THE GAME. MADAM RABBITT EXPLAINS WHAT HAPPENED NEXT: THE PLAYERS RUSH AS ONE INTO THE AIR, IGNORING THE BLAFFLE AND DODGING THE BLEEDERS, BOTH KEEPERS ABANDONED THE GHEB BASKETS AND THREW THE FLINT. THE POOR LITTLE SNIDGET SPENT UP AND DOWN THE PITCH SEEKING A MEANS OF ESCAPE, BUT THE WIZARDS IN THE CROWD FORCED IT BACK WITH REPELLING SPELLS. WELL, PRL, YOU KNOW HOW I AM ABOUT SNIDGET-FLINTING AND WHAT I GET LIKE WHEN MY TEMPER FLARES. I RAN INTO THE PITCH AND SCREAMED, "CHIEF BRACER, THIS IS NOT SPIRIT! LET THE SNIDGET GO FREE AND LET US WATCH THE NERLE GAME OF FLIDDITCH WHICH WE HAVE ALL COME TO SEE!" YOU'LL BELIEVE ME, PRL, ALL THE BRUTE DID WAS LAUGH AND THROW THE EMPTY BIRDCAGE AT ME. WELL, I SAW RED, PRL, I REALLY DID. WHEN THE POOR LITTLE SNIDGET FLEW 1. EQUIVALENT TO OVER A MILLION GALLEONS TODAY. WHETHER CHIEF BRACER INTENDED TO PAY HER BET IS A MERE POINT. 12 MY WAY I DID A SLIMMERING CHARM. YOU KNOW HOW GOOD MY SLIMMERING CHARMS ARE, PRL - OF COURSE IT WAS EASIER FOR ME TO AIM PROPERLY, NOT BEING MENTED IN A CIRCUMSTANCE AT THE TIME. THE LITTLE BIRD CAME ZIPPING INTO MY HAND, I STUFFED IT DOWN THE FRONT OF MY REEKS AND RAN LIKE FIRE. WELL, THEY CALIGHT

ME, BUT NOT BEFORE I'D GET HIM UP THE CHIMBYS AND RELEASE THE SNIDGET. CHIEF BRAGGE WAS VERY ANGRY AND FOR A MOMENT I THOUGHT I'D END UP A HANGED THAD, BUT WHEW, LUCKILY HIS ADVISERS CALMED HIM DOWN AND I WAS FINISHED TEN CALLERNS FOR DISRUPTING THE GAME. OTHERWISE I'VE NEVER HAD TEN CALLERNS IN MY LIFE, SEE THAT'S THE OLD FINE CHIEF. I'LL BEING THE LIVE WITH YOU SHORTLY, LUCKILY THEY DIDN'T TAKE THE HIPPENGRIP, AND I'LL TELL YOU THIS, PULL, CHIEF BRAGGE WOULD HAVE LOST MY WHITE & I'D HAD HINE, YOUR LIVING SISTER, MEDESTY MADAM RABNETT'S BRAVE ACTION MIGHT HAVE SAVED HINE SNIDGET, BUT SHE COULD NOT SAVE THEM ALL. CHIEF BRAGGE'S IDEA HAD HOWEVER CHANGED THE NATURE OF FLIDDITCH. CHILDEN SNIDGETS WERE THEN BEING RELEASED DURING ALL FLIDDITCH GAMES, HINE PLAYER HIN EACH TEAM (THE FLINTER) HAVING THE SAME TASK OF CATCHING IT. WHEN THE BIRD WAS 1000 KILLED, THE GAME WAS OVER AND THE FLINTER'S TEAM WAS AWARDED AN EXTRA HINE HUNDRED AND FIFTY POINTS, IN MEMORY OF THE HINE HUNDRED AND FIFTY CALLERNS PROMISED BY CHIEF BRAGGE. THE CHIEF LINDERTHEED THEN KEPT THE SNIDGET HIN THE PITCH BY USING THE REPELLING SPELLS MENTIONED BY MADAM RABNETT. BY THE MIDDLE OF THE FIFTEENTH CENTURY, HOWEVER, CHILDEN SNIDGET NUMBERS HAD FALLEN SEE WELL THAT THE WIZARDS' COUNCIL, NOW HEADED BY THE CONSIDERABLY MORE ENLIGHTENED FLORIDA CLAGG, MADE THE CHILDEN SNIDGET A PROTECTED SPECIES, ELIMINATING BOTH ITS KILLING AND ITS USE IN FLIDDITCH GAMES. THE MEDESTY RABNETT SNIDGET RESERVATION WAS FOUNDED IN SHIRSET AND A SUBSTITUTE FOR THE BIRD WAS FRANTICALLY SOUGHT TO ENABLE THE GAME OF FLIDDITCH TO PROCEED. THE INVENTION OF THE CHILDEN SNITCH IS CREDITED TO THE WIZARD RICHMAN WRIGHT OF GORIC'S COUNTRY. WHILE FLIDDITCH TEAMS ALL OVER THE COUNTRY TRIED TO FIND BIRD SUBSTITUTES FOR THE SNIDGET, WRIGHT, WHO WAS A SKILLED METAL-CHARGER, SET HIMSELF TO THE TASK OF CREATING A BALL THAT MIMICKED THE BEHAVIOUR AND FLIGHT PATTERNS OF THE SNIDGET. THAT HE SUCCEEDED PERFECTLY IS CLEAR FROM THE MANY ROLLS OF PARCHMENT HE LEFT BEHIND HIM HIN HIS DEATH (NOW IN THE POSSESSION OF A PRIVATE COLLECTOR), LISTING THE ORDERS THAT HE HAD RECEIVED FROM ALL OVER THE COUNTRY. THE CHILDEN SNITCH, AS RICHMAN CALLED HIS INVENTION, WAS A 1 1/4 WALNUT-SIZED BALL EXACTLY THE WEIGHT OF A SNIDGET. ITS SILVER WINGS HAD RETRACTIBLE POINTS LIKE THE SNIDGET'S, ENABLING IT TO CHANGE DIRECTION WITH THE LIGHTNING SPEED AND PRECISION OF ITS LIVING MODEL. UNLIKE THE SNIDGET, HOWEVER, THE

SNITCH HAD BEEN REWITCHED THE REMAIN WITHIN THE BOUNDARIES OF THE FIELD. THE INTRODUCTION OF THE GOLDEN SNITCH MAY BE SAID TO HAVE FINISHED THE PIONEER BEGIN THREE HUNDRED YEARS BEFORE THE HUNTERDITCH MARSH. HUNTERDITCH HAD BEEN TRULY BORN. CHAPTER FIVE ANTI-MUGGLE PRECAUTIONS IN 1872 THE WIZARD ZACHARIAS MILMS SET DOWN THE FIRST FULL DESCRIPTION OF THE GAME OF HUNTERDITCH. HE BEGAN BY EMPHASISING THE NEED FOR ANTI-MUGGLE SECURITY WHILE PLAYING THE GAME: "THESE AREAS OF DESERTED HIGHLAND FAR FROM MUGGLE HABITATIONS AND MAKE SURE THAT THEY CANNOT BE SEEN SINCE THEY TAKE OFF IN THEIR KITCHENS. MUGGLE-REPELLING CHAIRS ARE USEFUL IF THEY ARE SETTING UP A PERMANENT PITCH. IT IS ADVISABLE, THEN, TO PLAY AT NIGHT." WE BELIEVE THAT MILMS'S EXCELLENT ADVICE WAS NOT ALWAYS FOLLOWED FROM THE FACT THAT THE WIZARDS' COUNCIL ENJOINED ALL HUNTERDITCH-PLAYING WITHIN FIFTY MILES OF THEM IN 1882. CLEARLY THE POPULARITY OF THE GAME WAS INCREASING RAPIDLY, FOR THE COUNCIL FOUND IT NECESSARY TO AMEND THE BAN IN 1888, MAKING IT ILLEGAL TO PLAY WITHIN A HUNDRED MILES OF A TOWN. IN 1919, THE COUNCIL ISSUED THE FAMOUSLY WORDED DECREE THAT HUNTERDITCH SHOULD NOT BE PLAYED "ANYWHERE NEAR ANY PLACE WHERE THERE IS THE SLIGHTEST CHANCE THAT A MUGGLE MIGHT BE WATCHING OR WE'LL SEE THEM WELL THEY CAN PLAY WHILE CHAINED TO A DUNGEON WALL." AS EVERY SCHOOL-AGE WIZARD KNOWS, THE FACT THAT WE PLAY OUR KITCHENS IS PROBABLY OUR WORST-KEPT SECRET. THE MUGGLE ILLUSTRATION OF A WITCH IS COMPLETE WITHOUT A KITCHEN AND HOWEVER UNUSUAL THESE DRAWINGS ARE (FOR NONE OF THE KITCHENS DEPICTED BY MUGGLES COULD STAY UP IN THE AIR FOR A MOMENT), THEY REMIND US THAT WE WERE CARELESS FOR THREE HUNDRED YEARS TO BE SURPRISED THAT KITCHENS AND MAGIC ARE INEXTRICABLY LINKED IN THE MUGGLE MIND. APPROPRIATE SECURITY MEASURES WERE NOT ENFORCED UNTIL THE INTERNATIONAL STATUTE OF WIZARDING SECRECY OF 1872 MADE EVERY MINISTRY OF MAGIC DIRECTLY RESPONSIBLE FOR THE CONSEQUENCES OF MAGICAL SPORTS PLAYED WITHIN THEIR TERRITORIES. THIS SUBSEQUENTLY LED, IN BRITAIN, TO THE FORMATION OF THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS. HUNTERDITCH TEAMS THAT VIOLATED THE MINISTRY GUIDELINES WERE HENCEFORTH FORCED TO DISBAND. THE FIRST FAMOUS INSTANCE OF THIS WAS THE RANGERS, A 18 SCOTTISH TEAM REVENGED NOT ONLY FOR THEIR POOR HUNTERDITCH SKILLS BUT ALSO FOR THEIR POST-MATCH PARTIES. AFTER THEIR 1819 MATCH AGAINST THE

APPROPRIATE ARRANGEMENTS (SEE CHAPTER SEVEN), THE RANGERS NOT ONLY
 ALLOWED THEIR BLINDERS TO REMAIN AWAY INTO THE NIGHT, BUT ALSO SET
 OUT THE CAPTURE A FERRIDEAN BLACK FOR THEIR TEAM MASCOT. MINISTRY
 OF MAGIC REPRESENTATIVES APPREHENDED THEM AS THEY WERE FLYING
 OVER INVERNESS AND THE RANGERS NEVER PLAYED AGAIN.
 NEVLADAY'S FLUIDITCH TEAMS DO NOT PLAY LOCALLY, BUT TRAVEL THE
 PITCHES, WHICH HAVE BEEN SET UP BY THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL
 GAMES AND SPORTS WHERE ADEQUATE ANTI-MUGGLE SECURITY IS
 MAINTAINED. AS ZACHARIAS MUMPS SHE RIGHTLY SUGGESTED SIX
 HUNDRED YEARS AGO, FLUIDITCH PITCHES ARE SAFEST AND DESERTED PLACES.
 CHAPTER SIX CHANGES IN FLUIDITCH SINCE THE FIFTEENTH CENTURY
 PITCH ZACHARIAS MUMPS DESCRIBES THE FIFTEENTH-CENTURY PITCH AS
 HEAVY-SHAPED, FIVE HUNDRED FEET LONG, AND A HUNDRED AND EIGHTY FEET
 WIDE WITH A SMALL CENTRAL CIRCLE (APPROXIMATELY TWENTY FEET IN
 DIAMETER) IN THE MIDDLE. MUMPS TELLS US THAT 19 THE REFEREE (HER
 FLUIDER, AS HE HER SHE WAS THEN KNOWN), CARRIED THE FLUID BALLS
 INTO THIS CENTRAL CIRCLE WHILE THE FIFTEEN PLAYERS STOOD AROUND
 HIM. THE MOMENT THE BALLS WERE RELEASED (THE FLUIDER WAS TELLING
 BY THE REFEREE; SEE "FLUIDER" BELOW), THE PLAYERS RACED INTO THE AIR.
 THE CHAMPIONS IN MUMPS'S TIME WERE STILL LARGE BASKETS AND PEELS,
 AS SEEN IN FIG. C. IN 1820 FLINTILIS LIMPAVILLE WROTE A BOOK CALLED
 THE NEW SPART OF WARRIORS, WHICH INCLUDED A DIAGRAM OF THE
 SEVENTEENTH-CENTURY PITCH (SEE FIG. D). THERE WE SEE THE ADDITION OF
 WHAT WE KNOW AS "SCORING AREAS" (SEE "RULES" BELOW). THE BASKETS
 AND THE OF THE CHAMPIONS WERE CONSIDERABLY SMALLER AND HIGHER
 THAN IN MUMPS'S TIME. BY 1888 BASKETS HAD CEASED TO BE USED FOR
 SCORING AND WERE REPLACED WITH THE CHAMPIONS WE USE TODAY, AN
 INNOVATION REPORTED IN THE DAILY PROPHET OF THE TIME (SEE BELOW).
 THE FLUIDITCH PITCH HAS NOT ALTERED SINCE THAT TIME. FIG. C 18
 DIAGRAM FROM THE NEW SPART OF WARRIORS NEW SCORING AREAS
 CENTRAL CIRCLE FOR RELEASE OF BALLS FIG. D BRING BACK FLUID BASKETS!
 THAT WAS THE CRY HEARD FROM FLUIDITCH PLAYERS ACROSS THE NATION
 LAST NIGHT AS IT BECAME CLEAR THAT THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL
 GAMES AND SPORTS HAD DECIDED TO RETURN THE BASKETS USED FOR
 CENTURIES FOR CHAMPIONING IN FLUIDITCH. "WE'RE NOT RETURNING THEM,
 DON'T EXAGGERATE," SAID AN IRRITABLE-LOOKING DEPARTMENTAL
 REPRESENTATIVE LAST NIGHT WHEN ASKED THE COMMENT. "BASKETS, AS YOU
 MAY HAVE NOTICED, CAME IN DIFFERENT SIZES. WE HAVE FOUND IT

IMPOSSIBLE THE STANDARDISE BASKET SIZE SEE AS THE MADGE CHALPHISTS
 THEROUGHOUT BRITAIN EMBAL. SURELY YELL CAN SEE IT'S A MATTER OF
 FAIRNESS. I MEAN, THERE'S A TEAM UP NEAR BARNTHEN, THEY'VE GOT THESE
 MINUSCULE LITTLE BASKETS ATTACHED THE THE HOPPOUSING TEAM'S PHESTS,
 YELL CHILDEN'T GET A GRAPE IN THEM, AND UP THEIR HERN END THEY'VE
 GOT THESE GREAT WICKER CAGES SWINGING AROUND. IT'S NOT HEN, WE'VE
 SETTLED HEN A FIXED SIZING 17 INCH SIZE AND THAT'S IT. EVERYTHING
 NICE AND FAIR." AT THIS POINT, THE DEPARTMENTAL REPRESENTATIVE WAS
 FORCED THE RETREAT UNDER A HAIL OF BASKETS THROWN BY THE ANGRY
 DEMONSTRATORS ASSEMBLED IN THE HALL. ALTHOUGH THE ENSUING RIOT
 WAS LATER BLAMED HEN CHALKIN AGITATORS, THERE CAN BE NO DOUBT THAT
 ELIADITCH FANS ACROSS BRITAIN ARE TENACIOUSLY PERSEVERING THE END OF
 THE GAME AS WE KNOW IT. "T'WHEN'T BE T' SAME WITHELT BASKETS," SAID
 HEN APPLE-CHEEKED OLD WIZARD SADLY. "I REMEMBER WHEN I WERE A LAD,
 WE USED THE SET FIRE THE 'EM FOR A LAUGH DURING T' MATCH. YELL CAN'T DO
 THAT WITH CHAL FIFTHS, 'OLF T' PLIN'S GENE." DAILY PROPHET, 12
 FEBRUARY 1888 CALLS THE ELIAPPLE AS WE KNOW FROM GERTIE DIDDLE'S
 DIARY, THE ELIAPPLE WAS FROM EARLIEST TIMES MADE OF LEATHER. ALONE
 OF THE FEWER ELIADITCH BALLS, THE ELIAPPLE WAS NOT ORIGINALLY
 ENCHANTED, BUT MERELY A PATCHED LEATHER BALL, HOTTEN WITH A STRAP
 (SEE FIG. 2), AS IT HAD THE BE CALIGHT AND THEREIN HEN-HANDED. SOME OLD
 ELIAPPLES HAVE FINGER RINGS. WITH THE DISCOVERY OF GRIPPING
 CHARMS IN 1895, HOWEVER, STRAPS AND FINGER RINGS HAVE BECOME
 UNNECESSARY, ASA THE CHASER IS ABLE THE KEEP A HEN-HANDED HOLD HEN
 THE CHARMED LEATHER WITHELT SUCH AIDS. 20 THE MODERN ELIAPPLE IS
 TWELVE INCHES IN DIAMETER AND SEAMLESS. IT WAS FIRST COLOURED
 SCARLET IN THE WINTER OF 1911, AFTER A GAME WHEN HEAVY RAIN HAD
 MADE IT INDISTINGUISHABLE FROM THE MUDDY GROUND WHENEVER IT WAS
 DROPPED. CHASERS WERE ALSO BECOMING INCREASINGLY IRRITATED BY THE
 NECESSITY OF DIVING CONTINUALLY TOWARDS THE GROUND THE RETRIEVE
 THE ELIAPPLE WHENEVER THEY MISSED A CATCH AND SEE, SHORTLY AFTER THE
 ELIAPPLE'S CHANGE OF COLOUR, THE WITCH DAISY PENNIFIELD HAD THE IDEA
 OF BOWITCHING THE ELIAPPLE SEE THAT IF DROPPED, IT WOULD FALL SILENTLY
 EARTHWARDS AS THOUGH SINKING THROUGH WATER, MEANING THAT
 CHASERS COULD GRAB IT IN MID-AIR. THE "PENNIFIELD ELIAPPLE" IS STILL
 USED TODAY. ANCIENT ELIAPPLES MODERN ELIAPPLE FIG. 2 THE BLUDGERS
 THE FIRST BLUDGERS (OR "BLUDGERS") WERE, AS WE HAVE SEEN, FLYING
 REEDS, AND IN MILPS'S TIME THEY HAD MERELY PROGRESSED THE REEDS

CARVED INTO THE SHAPE OF BALLS. THESE DO HAVE ONE IMPORTANT DISADVANTAGE, HOWEVER: THEY COULD BE CRACKED BY THE MAGICALLY REINFORCED BEATERS' RATS OF THE FIFTEENTH CENTURY, IN WHICH CASE ALL PLAYERS WOULD BE PUNISHED BY FLYING GRAVEL FOR THE REMAINDER OF THE GAME. IT WAS PROBABLY FOR THIS REASON THAT SOME HILDBITCH TEAMS BEGAN EXPERIMENTING WITH METAL BILDGERS IN THE EARLY SIXTEENTH CENTURY. AGATHA CLARK, EXPERT IN ANCIENT WIZARDING ARTIFACTS, HAS IDENTIFIED NEARLY TWELVE LEAD BILDGERS DATING FROM THIS PERIOD, DISCOVERED EITHER IN IRISH PEAT Bogs AND ENGLISH MARSHES. "THEY ARE UNDOUBTEDLY BILDGERS RATHER THAN CANNON BALLS," SHE WRITES. THE FAINT INDENTATIONS OF MAGICALLY REINFORCED BEATERS' RATS ARE VISIBLE AND ONE CAN SEE THE DISTINCTIVE MARKINGS OF MANUFACTURE BY A WIZARD (AS OPPOSED TO A MUGGLE) - THE SPHERICALITY OF LINE, THE PERFECT SYMMETRY. A FINAL CLUE WAS THE FACT THAT EACH AND EVERY ONE OF THEM WHIZZED AROUND MY STUDY AND ATTEMPTED TO BOMB ME THE MOMENT WHEN RELEASED FROM ITS CASE. LEAD WAS EVENTUALLY DISCOVERED TO BE THE BEST FOR THE PURPOSE OF BILDBER MANUFACTURE (ANY INDENTATION LEFT IN A BILDBER WILL AFFECT ITS ABILITY TO FLY STRAIGHT). NEVADAAYS ALL BILDGERS ARE MADE OF IRON. THEY ARE TEN INCHES IN DIAMETER, & ALL BILDGERS ARE BOWITCHED TO CHASE PLAYERS INDISCRIMINATELY. IF LEFT TO THEIR OWN DEVICES, THEY WILL ATTACK THE PLAYER CLOSEST TO THEM, HENCE THE BEATERS' TASK IS TO BOMB THE BILDGERS AS FAR AWAY FROM THEIR OWN TEAM AS POSSIBLE. THE CHILDBEN SNITCH THE CHILDBEN SNITCH IS WALNUT-SIZED, AS WAS THE CHILDBEN SNIDGET. IT IS BOWITCHED TO EVADE CAPTURE AS LONG AS POSSIBLE. THERE IS A TALE THAT A CHILDBEN SNITCH EVADED CAPTURE FOR SIX MONTHS IN BODMIN MERE IN 1884, BOTH TEAMS FINALLY GIVING UP IN DISGUST AT THEIR SEEDERS' POOR PERFORMANCE. CHURCH WIZARDS FAMILIAR WITH THE AREA INSIST TO THIS DAY THAT THE SNITCH IS STILL LIVING WILD IN THE MERE, THOUGH I HAVE NOT BEEN ABLE TO CONFIRM THIS STORY. PLAYERS THE KEEPER THE POSITION OF KEEPER HAS CERTAINLY EXISTED SINCE THE THIRTEENTH CENTURY (SEE CHAPTER FOUR), THOUGH THE ROLE HAS CHANGED SINCE THAT TIME. ACCORDING TO ZACHARIAS WILMS, THE KEEPER SHOULD BE FIRST TO REACH THE CHAL BASKETS AND IT IS HIS JOB TO PREVENT THE HILDAFFLE ENTERING THEREIN. THE KEEPER SHOULD BEWARE OF STRAYING TOO FAR TOWARDS THE OTHER END OF THE 22 PITCH, IN CASE HIS BASKETS COME UNDER THREAT IN HIS ABSENCE. HOWEVER, A FAST KEEPER MAY BE ABLE TO SCORE A CHAL AND

THEN RETURN THE HIS BASKETS IN TIME TO PREVENT THE EITHER TEAM
REALISING. IT IS A MATTER FOR THE INDIVIDUAL CONSCIENCE OF THE
KEEPER. IT IS CLEAR FROM THIS THAT IN MUMPS'S DAY THE KEEPERS
PERFORMED LIKE CHASERS WITH EXTRA RESPONSIBILITIES. THEY WERE
ALLOWED TO MOVE ALL OVER THE PITCH AND THE SCORE CHALS. BY THE TIME
HUMPHRIES LYMPHALL WROTE THE NINE SPENT OF WARHEADS IN
1820, HOWEVER, THE KEEPER'S JOB HAD BEEN SIMPLIFIED. THE SCORING
AREAS HAD NOW BEEN ADDED TO THE PITCH AND THE KEEPERS WERE ADVISED
TO REMAIN WITHIN THEM, GUARDING THEIR CHAL BASKETS, THOUGH
KEEPERS MAY FLY OUT OF THIS AREA IN AN ATTEMPT TO INTIMIDATE
OPPOSING CHASERS OR HEAD THEM OFF EARLY. THE BEATERS THE DUTIES
OF THE BEATERS HAVE CHANGED LITTLE THROUGH THE CENTURIES AND IT IS
LIKELY THAT BEATERS HAVE EXISTED EVER SINCE THE INTRODUCTION OF THE
BLIDGERS. THEIR FIRST DUTY IS TO GUARD THEIR TEAM MEMBERS FROM THE
BLIDGERS, WHICH THEY DO WITH THE AID OF BATS (HENCE CLUCK, SEE
GEOFFREY DUNN'S LETTER IN CHAPTER THREE). BEATERS HAVE NEVER
BEEN 24 CHAL-SCORERS, NOR IS THERE ANY INDICATION THAT THEY HAVE
HANDLED THE BALL. BEATERS NEED A GOOD DEAL OF PHYSICAL STRENGTH
TO REPEL THE BLIDGERS. THIS IS THEREFORE THE POSITION THAT, MORE
THAN ANY OTHER, HAS TENDED TO BE TAKEN BY WIZARDS RATHER THAN
WITCHES. BEATERS ALSO NEED TO HAVE AN EXCELLENT SENSE OF BALANCE, AS
IT IS SOMETIMES NECESSARY FOR THEM TO TAKE BOTH HANDS FROM THEIR
BROOMS FOR A DELICATE-HANDED ASSAULT ON A BLIDGER. THE CHASERS
CHASER IS THE OLDEST POSITION IN BLIDDITCH, FOR THE GAME SINCE
CONSISTED WHOLLY OF CHAL-SCORING. THE CHASERS THROW THE BALL
TO EACH OTHER AND SCORE TEN POINTS FOR EVERY TIME THEY GET IT
THROUGH ONE OF THE CHAL HOOPS. THE ONLY SIGNIFICANT CHANGE IN
CHASING CAME ABOUT IN 1884, ONE YEAR AFTER THE SUBSTITUTION OF
CHAL HOOPS FOR CHAL BASKETS. A NEW RULE WAS INTRODUCED WHICH
STATED THAT ONLY THE CHASER CARRYING THE BALL COULD ENTER THE
SCORING AREA. IF MORE THAN ONE CHASER ENTERED, THE CHAL WOULD BE
DISALLOWED. THE RULE WAS DESIGNED TO ELIMINATE "STEERING" (SEE "FELLS"
REVIEW), A MOVE BY WHICH TWO CHASERS WOULD ENTER THE SCORING AREA
AND RAMP THE KEEPER ASIDE, LEAVING A CHAL HOOP CLEAR FOR THE THIRD
CHASER. REACTION TO THIS NEW RULE WAS REPORTED IN THE DAILY
PROPHET OF THE TIME, AS FOLLOWS: "AREN'T CHASERS! THAT WAS
THE STUNNED REACTION OF BLIDDITCH FANS ACROSS BRITAIN LAST NIGHT
WHEN THE SO-CALLED "STEERING PENALTY" WAS ANNOUNCED BY THE

DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS LAST NIGHT. "INSTANCES OF STEERING HAVE BEEN IN THE INCREASE," SAID A HARASSED-LOOKING DEPART MENTAL REPRESENTATIVE LAST NIGHT. "WE FEEL THAT THIS NEW RULE WILL ELIMINATE THE SEVERE KEEPER INJURIES WE HAVE BEEN SEEING ONLY THEE OFTEN. FROM NOW ON, ONE CHASER WILL ATTEMPT THE BEAT THE KEEPER, AS OPPOSED THE THREE CHASERS BEATING THE KEEPER UP. EVERYTHING WILL BE MUCH CLEANER AND FAIRER." AT THIS POINT THE DEPARTMENTAL REPRESENTATIVE WAS FORCED THE RETREAT AS THE ANGRY CREWLD STARTED THE REMOVED HIM WITH ENLARGES. WIZARDS FROM THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL LAW ENFORCEMENT ARRIVED THE DISPERSE THE CREWLD, WHO WERE THREATENING THE STEERING THE MINISTER OF MAGIC HIMSELF. ONE FRECKLE-FACED SIX-YEAR-OLD LEFT THE HALL IN TEARS. "I LOVED STEERING," HE SHERED THE THE DAILY PROPHET. "ME AND ME DAD LIKE WATCHING THEM KEEPER'S FLATTENED. I DIDN'T WANT THE SEE THE ENLARGED THE MORE." DAILY PROPHET, 22 JUNE 1884 THE SEEKER USUALLY THE LIGHTEST AND FASTEST FLIERS, SEEKERS NEED BOTH A SHARP EYE AND THE ABILITY THE FLY ONE- OR TWO-HANDED. GIVEN THEIR IMMENSE IMPORTANCE IN THE OVERALL OUTCOME OF THE 2ND MATCH, AND THE CAPTURE OF THE SNITCH SEE OFTEN SNATCHES VICTORY FROM THE LIPS OF DEFEAT. SEEKERS ARE MOST LIKELY TO BE ABLE BY MEMBERS OF THE OPPOSITION. INDEED, WHILE THERE IS CONSIDERABLE GLAMOUR ATTACHED THE THE POSITION OF SEEKER, AND THEY ARE TRADITIONALLY THE BEST FLIERS ON THE PITCH, THEY ARE USUALLY THE PLAYERS WHO RECEIVE THE WORST INJURIES. "TAKE OUT THE SEEKER" IS THE FIRST RULE IN BRUTUS SCRIMPHEUR'S THE BEATERS' BIBLE. RULES THE FOLLOWING RULES WERE SET DOWN BY THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS UPON ITS ADOPTION IN 1880: 1. THOUGH THERE IS NO LIMIT IMPOSED ON THE HEIGHT THE WHICH A PLAYER MAY RISE DURING THE GAME, HE OR SHE MUST NOT STRAY EVER THE BOUNDARY LINES OF THE PITCH. SHOULD A PLAYER FLY EVER THE BOUNDARY, HIS OR HER TEAM MUST SURRENDER THE ENLARGE THE THE OPPOSING TEAM. 2. THE CAPTAIN OF A TEAM MAY CALL FOR "TIME OUT" BY SIGNALLING THE THE REFEREE. THIS IS THE ONLY TIME PLAYERS' FEET ARE ALLOWED TO TOUCH THE GROUND DURING A MATCH. TIME OUT MAY BE EXTENDED TO A TWO-MINUTE PERIOD IF A GAME HAS LASTED MORE THAN TWELVE MINUTES. FAILURE TO RETURN THE THE PITCH AFTER TWO MINUTES LEADS TO THE TEAM'S DISQUALIFICATION. 3. THE REFEREE MAY AWARD PENALTIES AGAINST A TEAM. THE CHASER TAKING THE PENALTY WILL FLY FROM THE CENTRAL CIRCLE TOWARDS THE SCORING AREA.

ALL PLAYERS EITHER THAN THE 2ND HOPPING KEEPER MUST KEEP WELL BACK WHILE THE PENALTY IS TAKEN. 4. THE HURDLE MAY BE TAKEN FROM ANOTHER PLAYER'S GRASP BUT UNDER THE CIRCUMSTANCES MUST HAVE PLAYER SEIZE FIELD OR ANY PART OF ANOTHER PLAYER'S ANATOMY. 5. IN THE CASE OF INJURY, THE SUBSTITUTION OF PLAYERS WILL TAKE PLACE. THE TEAM WILL PLAY ON WITHOUT THE INJURED PLAYER. 6. HANDS MAY BE TAKEN ON THE PITCH BUT MUST UNDER THE CIRCUMSTANCES WHATSOEVER BE USED AGAINST HOPPING TEAM MEMBERS, ANY HOPPING TEAM MEMBER'S KNEE, THE REFEREE, AND OF THE BALLS, OR ANY MEMBER OF THE CROWD. 7. A GAME OF HURDITCH ENDS ONLY WHEN THE CHILDEN SNITCH HAS BEEN CALLED, OR BY MUTUAL CONSENT OF THE TWO TEAM CAPTAINS. FIELD RULES ARE OF COURSE "MADE TO BE KNOWN." SEVEN HUNDRED HURDITCH RULES ARE LISTED IN THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS RECORDS, AND ALL OF THEM ARE KNOWN TO HAVE OCCURRED DURING THE FINAL OF THE FIRST EVER WORLD CUP IN 1992. THE FULL LIST OF THESE RULES, HOWEVER, HAS NEVER BEEN MADE AVAILABLE TO THE WIZARDING PUBLIC. IT IS THE DEPARTMENT'S VIEW THAT WITCHES AND WIZARDS WHO SEE THE LIST "MIGHT GET IDEAS." 1. THE RIGHT TO CARRY A HAND AT ALL TIMES WAS ESTABLISHED BY THE INTERNATIONAL CONFEDERATION OF WIZARDS IN 1892, WHEN MUGGLE PERSECUTION WAS AT ITS HEIGHT AND THE WIZARDS WERE PLANNING THEIR RETREAT INTO HIDING. 2. I WAS FORTUNATE ENOUGH TO GAIN ACCESS TO THE DOCUMENTS RELATING TO THESE RULES WHILE RESEARCHING THIS BOOK AND CAN CONFIRM THAT THE PUBLIC GOOD CAN COME OF THEIR PUBLICATION. NINETY PERCENT OF THE RULES LISTED ARE, IN ANY CASE, IMPOSSIBLE AS LONG AS THE BAN ON USING HANDS AGAINST THE HOPPING TEAM IS UPHOLD (THIS BAN WAS IMPOSED IN 1500). OF THE REMAINING TEN PERCENT, IT IS SAFE TO SAY THAT MOST WOULD NOT EVEN THE DIRTIEST PLAYER; FOR EXAMPLE, "SETTING FIRE TO AN HOPPERENT'S KNEE," "ATTACKING AN HOPPERENT'S KNEE WITH A CLUB," "ATTACKING AN HOPPERENT WITH AN AXE." THIS IS NOT TO SAY THAT MODERN HURDITCH PLAYERS NEVER READ RULES. TEN THOUSAND RULES ARE LISTED BELOW. THE CORRECT HURDITCH TERM FOR EACH RULE IS GIVEN IN THE FIRST COLUMN. NAME APPLIES THE DESCRIPTION. 3. ALL PLAYERS SEIZING HOPPERENT'S KNEE TO STOP OR HINDER KATCHING ALL PLAYERS FLYING WITH INTENT TO COLLIDE. 4. ALL PLAYERS LEAVING KNEE HANDLES WITH A VIEW TO STEERING HOPPERENT OFF COURSE. 5. KATCHING BEATERS ONLY HITTING BLUDGEON TOWARDS CROWD.

NECESSITATING A HALT OF THE GAME AS OFFICIALS RUSH THE PROTECT
BYSTANDERS. SOMETIMES USED BY UNDISCIPLINED PLAYERS TO PREVENT
AN OPPRESSING CHASER SCORING CHECKING ALL PLAYERS EXCESSIVE USE OF
ELBOWS TOWARDS OPPONENTS 27 PLACING KEEPER ONLY FAYERSACKING
CHASERS ONLY STICKING AND PERTINEN OF ANATHENY THROUGH CHAL
HHEP THE PLUNCH ELIAPLE HLT. THE KEEPER IS SUPPOSED THE KNEED THE
CHAL HHEP FROM THE FRONT RATHER THAN THE REAR HAND STILL HEN
ELIAPLE AS IT GOES THROUGH CHAL HHEP (ELIAPLE MUST BE THROUGH)
ELIAPLECHECKING CHASERS ONLY TAMPERING WITH ELIAPLE, E.G.,
PLUNCTURING IT SEE THAT IT FALLS MORE HILICLY HIR ZIGZAGS SNITCHNIP
ALL PLAYERS BUT SEEKER AND PLAYER EITHER THAN SEEKER THINKING
HIR CATCHING THE GOLDEN SNITCH STEERING CHASERS ONLY MORE THAN
HNE CHASER ENTERING THE SCORING AREA REFEREE'S REFEREEING A
ELIIDDITCH MATCH WAS HENCE A TASK FOR ONLY THE BRAVEST WITCHES AND
WIZARDS. ZACHARIAS MILMS TELLS US THAT A DHERFIELD REFEREE CALLED
CYPRIANHILDE DIED DURING A FRIENDLY MATCH BETWEEN LOCAL WIZARDS
IN 1857. THE ORIGINATOR OF THE CLUSE WAS NEVER CAUGHT BUT IS
BELIEVED TO HAVE BEEN A MEMBER OF THE CIRCLE. WHILE THERE HAVE BEEN
NE PROVEN REFEREE SLAYINGS SINCE, THERE HAVE BEEN SEVERAL
INCIDENCES OF BHEEM-TAMPERING OVER THE CENTURIES, THE MOST
DANGEROUS BEING THE TRANSFORMATION OF THE REFEREE'S BHEEM INTO A
PERTNEY, SEE THAT HE OR SHE IS WHISKED AWAY FROM THE MATCH
HALFWAY THROUGH AND TURNS UP MONTHS LATER IN THE SAHARA
DESERT. THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS HAS ISSUED
STRICT GUIDELINES ON THE SECURITY MEASURES RELATING THE PLAYERS'
BHEEMS AND THESE KN INCIDENTS ARE NEARLY, HANDFULLY, EXTREMELY
RARE. THE EFFECTIVE ELIIDDITCH REFEREE NEEDS TO BE MORE THAN AN
EXPERT FLIER. HE OR SHE HAS TO WATCH THE ANTICS OF FIFTEEN
PLAYERS AT HENCE AND THE MOST COMMON REFEREE'S INJURY IS
CONSEQUENTLY NECK STRAIN. AT PROFESSIONAL MATCHES THE REFEREE IS
ASSISTED BY OFFICIALS WHO STAND AROUND THE BOUNDARIES OF THE PITCH
AND ENSURE THAT NEITHER PLAYERS NOR BALLS STRAY OVER THE HILT
PERIMETER. IN BRITAIN, ELIIDDITCH REFEREES ARE SELECTED BY THE
DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS. THEY HAVE TO TAKE
RIGOROUS FLYING TESTS AND AN EXACTING WRITTEN EXAMINATION ON
THE RULES OF ELIIDDITCH AND PROVE, THROUGH A SERIES OF INTENSIVE
TRIALS, THAT THEY WILL NOT HIND OR CLUSE OFFENSIVE PLAYERS EVEN
UNDER SEVERE PRESSURE. CHAPTER SEVEN ELIIDDITCH TEAMS OF BRITAIN

AND IRELAND THE NECESSITY FOR KEEPING THE GAME OF HURLIDITCH
A SECRET FROM MUGGLES MEANS THAT THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL
GAMES AND SPORTS HAS HAD TO LIMIT THE NUMBER OF GAMES PLAYED
EACH YEAR. WHILE AMATEUR GAMES ARE PERMITTED AS LONG AS THE
APPROPRIATE GUIDELINES ARE FOLLOWED, PROFESSIONAL HURLIDITCH TEAMS
HAVE BEEN LIMITED TO IN NUMBER SINCE 1879 WHEN THE LEAGUE WAS
ESTABLISHED. AT THAT TIME, THE THIRTEEN BEST HURLIDITCH TEAMS IN
BRITAIN AND IRELAND WERE SELECTED TO JOIN THE LEAGUE AND ALL OTHERS
WERE ASKED TO DISBAND. THE THIRTEEN TEAMS CONTINUE TO COMPETE
EACH YEAR FOR THE LEAGUE CUP. AMPLY ARMS THIS NORTHERN
ENGLISH TEAM WAS FOUNDED IN 1812. ITS KICKS ARE PALE BLUE,
EMBELLISHED WITH A SILVER ARM. ARMS FANS WILL AGREE THAT THEIR
TEAM'S MOST GLORIOUS HOUR WAS THEIR 1922 DEFEAT OF THE TEAM WHO
WERE THEN THE EUROPEAN CHAMPIONS, THE FRATSA VULTURES, IN A
MATCH THAT LASTED SIXTEEN DAYS IN CONDITIONS OF DENSE FOG AND RAIN.
THE BLUE SLIPSTICKERS' END PRACTICE OF SHOOTING ARMS INTO THE
AIR FROM THEIR HANDS EVERY TIME THEIR CHASERS SCORED WAS BANNED BY
THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS IN 1879, WHEN ONE
OF THESE WEAPONS PIERCED THE REFEREE ALBERT POTT THROUGH THE
NECK. THERE IS TRADITIONALLY FIERCE RIVALRY BETWEEN THE ARMS
AND THE WIMBORNE WASPS (SEE BELOW). BALLYCASTLE KATS NORTHERN
IRELAND'S MOST CELEBRATED HURLIDITCH TEAM HAS BEEN THE HURLIDITCH
LEAGUE A TOTAL OF TWENTY-SEVEN TIMES TO DATE, MAKING IT THE SECOND
MOST SUCCESSFUL IN THE LEAGUE'S HISTORY. THE KATS WEAR BLACK KICKS
WITH A SCARLET K BAT ACROSS THE CHEST. THEIR FAMOUS MASCOT KARRY
THE FALCON IS ALSO WELL-KNOWN AS THE BAT FEATURED IN BLITTERBEER
ADVERTISEMENTS (KARRY SAYS: I'M JUST KATTY ABOUT BLITTERBEER!).
CARPENTERS CATAPULTS THE WELSH CATAPULTS, FORMED IN 1902, WEAR
VERTICALLY STRIPED KICKS OF LIGHT GREEN AND SCARLET. THEIR
DISTINGUISHED BLUE HISTORY INCLUDES EIGHTEEN LEAGUE WINS AND A
FAMOUS TRIUMPH IN THE EUROPEAN CUP FINAL OF 1956, WHEN THEY
DEFEATED THE NORWEGIAN KARASIN KITES. THE TRAGIC DEATH OF THEIR
MOST FAMOUS PLAYER, "DANGEROUS" DAI LLEWELLYN, WHO WAS EATEN BY
A CHIMERA WHILE ON HOLIDAY IN MYRKENES, GREECE, RESULTED IN A DAY
OF NATIONAL MOURNING FOR ALL WELSH WITCHES AND WIZARDS. THE
DANGEROUS DAI COMMEMORATIVE MEDAL IS NOW AWARDED AT THE END OF
EACH SEASON TO THE LEAGUE PLAYER WHO HAS TAKEN THE MOST
EXCITING AND DANGEROUS RISKS DURING A GAME. CHIEFLY CARPENTERS THE

CHILDEY CANNONS' GLORY DAYS MAY BE CONSIDERED BY MANY THE BE EVER, BUT THEIR DEVOTED FANS LIVE IN HOPE OF A RENAISSANCE. THE CANNONS HAVE BEEN THE LEAGUE TWENTYTHREE TIMES, BUT THE LAST TIME THEY DID SEE WAS IN 1872 AND THEIR PERFORMANCE EVER THE LAST CENTURY HAS BEEN LACKLUSTRE. THE CHILDEY CANNONS WEAR REDS OF BRIGHT RED STRANGE ORNAMENTED WITH A SPEEDING CANNON BALL AND A BELLIE "C" IN BLACK. THE CLUB MOTTOS WAS CHANGED IN 1792 FROM "WE SHALL OVERCOME" TO "LET'S ALL JUST KEEP OUR FINGERS CROSSED AND HOPE FOR THE BEST." FALCONHILL FALCONS THE FALCONS WEAR DARK-GREY AND WHITE REDS WITH A FALCON-HEAD EMBLEM ACROSS THE CHEST. THE FALCONS ARE KNOWN FOR HARD PLAY, A REPUTATION CONSOLIDATED BY THEIR WORLD-FAMOUS BEATERS, KEVIN AND KARL BREADBEATH, WHO PLAYED FOR THE CLUB FROM 1958 TO 1987 AND WHOSE ACTS RESULTED IN NO FEWER THAN FORTY-SEVEN SUSPENSIONS FROM THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS. CLUB MOTTOS: "LET US WIN, BUT IF WE CANNOT WIN, LET US BREAK A FEW HEADS." FLYHEAD FLYERS THE FLYHEAD FLYERS IS A VERY OLD WELSH CLUB (FOUNDED 1298), NOTABLE AMONG ELDRITCH TEAMS AROUND THE WORLD BECAUSE IT HAS ONLY EVER HIRED WITCHES. FLYER REDS ARE DARK GREEN WITH A GOLDEN TAIL FEATHER ON THE CHEST. THE FLYERS' DEFEAT OF THE FLYING FLYERS IN 1955 IS WIDELY AGREED TO HAVE BEEN ONE OF THE FINEST ELDRITCH GAMES EVER SEEN. FLYING OVER A SEVEN-DAY PERIOD, THE GAME WAS BROUGHT TO AN END BY A SPECTACULAR SNITCH CAPTURE BY THE FLYER SEEKER GYNNIS GRIFFITHS. THE 84 FLYERS CAPTAIN RUDOLF BRAND FAMILIARLY DISMOUNTED FROM HIS BROOM AT THE END OF THE MATCH AND PROPOSED MARRIAGE TO HIS OPPOSITE NUMBER, GWYNETHYNN MORGAN, WHO ENGAGED HIM WITH HER CLEANSLEEP FIVE. KENMORE KESTRELS THIS IRISH SIDE WAS FOUNDED IN 1291 AND IS POPULAR WORLDWIDE FOR THE SPIRITED DISPLAYS OF THEIR LEOPARD-LIKE MASCOTS AND THE ACCOMPLISHED HARP PLAYING OF THEIR SLIPPERERS. THE KESTRELS WEAR EMERALD-GREEN REDS WITH TWO YELLOW "K"s BACK THE BACK ON THE CHEST. DARREN HOFER, KESTREL KEEPER 1999-2000, CAPTAINED THE IRISH NATIONAL TEAM THREE TIMES AND IS CREDITED WITH THE INVENTION OF THE CHASER FLYING-HEAD ATTACKING FERMATION (SEE CHAPTER TEN). MOUNTAIN MACPIES THE MACPIES ARE THE MOST SUCCESSFUL TEAM IN THE HISTORY OF THE BRITISH AND IRISH LEAGUE, WHICH THEY HAVE WON THIRTY-TWO TIMES. TWICE EUROPEAN CHAMPIONS, THE MACPIES HAVE FANS ACROSS THE GLOBE. THEIR MANY OUTSTANDING PLAYERS INCLUDE

THE SEEKER CLINIC MURRAY (DIED 1742), WHO HENCE PETITIONED FOR A "FASTER SNITCH BECAUSE THIS IS JUST THE EASY," AND HAMISH MACFARLAN (CAPTAIN 1757-88), WHO FOLLOWED HIS SUCCESSFUL HOLIDITCH CAREER WITH AN EQUALLY ILLUSTRIOUS PERIOD AS KS HEAD OF THE DEPARTMENT OF MAGICAL GAMES AND SPORTS. THE MAGPIES WEAR BLACK AND WHITE STRIPES WITH ONE MAGPIE ON THE CHEST AND ANOTHER ON THE BACK. PRIDE OF PEERTREE THIS TEAM COMES FROM THE ISLE OF SKYE, WHERE IT WAS FOUNDED IN 1272. THE "PRIDES," AS THEY ARE KNOWN TO THEIR FANS, WEAR DEEP-PURPLE STRIPES WITH A GOLD STAR ON THE CHEST. THEIR FIRST FAMILIAR CHAIR, CATHERINA MCCORMACK, CAPTAINED THE TEAM TO TWO LEAGUE WINS IN THE 1780S, AND PLAYED FOR SCOTLAND THIRTY-SIX TIMES. HER DAUGHTER MAGGIEAN CURRENTLY PLAYS KEEPER FOR THE TEAM. HER SON DIRLEY IS LEAD GUITARIST WITH THE POPULAR WIZARDING BAND THE WEIRD SISTERS. PLODDMERE UNITED FOUNDED IN 1188, PLODDMERE UNITED IS THE ELDEST TEAM IN THE LEAGUE. PLODDMERE HAS TWENTY-TWO LEAGUE WINS AND TWO EUROPEAN CUP TRIUMPHS TO ITS CREDIT. ITS TEAM ANTHEM "BEAT BACK THESE BLOODSUCKERS, KIDS, AND CHILDEN THAT BELIEVE THERE" WAS RECENTLY RECORDED BY THE SINGING SHREKNESS CECILIA WARRICK THE RAISE FUNDS FOR ST. MUNGIE'S HOSPITAL FOR MAGICAL MALADIES AND INJURIES. PLODDMERE PLAYERS WEAR NAVY-BLUE STRIPES BEARING THE CLUB EMBLEM OF TWO CROSSED GOLDEN BROOMSICKLES. RE TUNTS-HILL TERNADERS THE TERNADERS WEAR RED-BLUE STRIPES WITH A WHITE "T" IN DARK BLUE ON THE CHEST AND BACK. FOUNDED IN 1520, THE TERNADERS ENJOYED THEIR GREATEST PERIOD OF SUCCESS IN THE EARLY TWENTIETH CENTURY WHEN, CAPTAINED BY SEEKER RICHARD PLYMPHEN, THEY WON THE LEAGUE CUP FIVE TIMES IN A ROW. A BRITISH AND IRISH RECORD. RICHARD PLYMPHEN PLAYED SEEKER FOR ENGLAND TWENTY-TWO TIMES AND HELDS THE BRITISH RECORD FOR FASTEST CAPTURE OF A SNITCH DURING A GAME (THREE AND A HALF SECONDS, AGAINST CARRP-HILL CATAPULTS, 1721). WIGTHEN WANDERERS THIS KEEPER'S CLUB WAS FOUNDED IN 1422 BY THE SEVEN OFFSPRING OF A WIZARDING KITCHEN NAMED WALTER PARKIN. THE FOUR BROTHERS AND THREE SISTERS WERE BY ALL ACCOUNTS A FEARFUL TEAM WHO RARELY LOST A MATCH. PARTLY, IT IS SAID, BECAUSE OF THE INTIMIDATION FELT BY OPPOSING TEAMS AT THE SIGHT OF WALTER STANDING ON THE SIDELINES WITH A WAND IN ONE HAND AND A MEAT CLEAVER IN THE OTHER. A PARKIN DESCENDANT HAS OFTEN BEEN FOUND ON THE WIGTHEN TEAM EVER THE CENTURIES AND IN TRIBUTE TO THEIR

ORIGINS, THE PLAYERS WEAR BLUE-RED STRIPES WITH A SILVER GREAT
 CLAYTON UPON THE CHEST. WIMBORNE WASPS THE WIMBORNE WASPS
 WEAR HORIZONTALLY STRIPED STRIPES OF YELLOW AND BLACK WITH A WASP
 UPON THEIR CHESTS. FOUNDED BY IN 1812, THE WASPS HAVE BEEN
 EIGHTEEN TIMES LEAGUE WINNERS AND TWICE SEMI-FINALISTS IN THE
 EUROPEAN CUP. THEY ARE ALLEGED TO HAVE TAKEN THEIR NAME FROM A
 NASTY INCIDENT WHICH OCCURRED DURING A MATCH AGAINST THE
 APPLEBY ARROWS IN THE MID-SEVENTEENTH CENTURY, WHEN A BEATER
 FLYING PAST A TREE ON THE EDGE OF THE PITCH NOTICED A WASP'S NEST
 AMONG THE BRANCHES AND BATTED IT TOWARDS THE ARROWS' SEEDER,
 WHO WAS THEN BADLY STUNG THAT HE HAD TO RETIRE FROM THE GAME.
 WIMBORNE THEN AND THEREAFTER ADOPTED THE WASP AS THEIR BLACK
 EMBLEM. WASP FANS (ALSO KNOWN AS "STINGERS") TRADITIONALLY BLIZZ
 ARDLY TO DISTRACT OPPOSING CHASERS WHEN THEY ARE TAKING
 PENALTIES. CHAPTER EIGHT THE SPREAD OF HURLDITCH WORLDWIDE
 EUROPE HURLDITCH WAS WELL ESTABLISHED IN IRELAND BY THE
 FIFTEENTH CENTURY, AS PROVED BY ZACHARIAS MYND'S ACCOUNT OF A
 MATCH IN 1488: "A TEAM OF WARLOCKS FROM CHIRK FLEW OVER FOR A
 GAME IN LANCASHIRE AND DID OFFEND THE LOCALS BY BEATING THEIR
 HEROES SOUNDLY. THE IRISHMEN KNEW TRICKS WITH THE HURLDITCH THAT
 HAD NOT BEEN SEEN IN LANCASHIRE BEFORE AND HAD TO FLEE THE VILLAGE
 FOR FEAR OF LOSING THEIR LIVES WHEN THE CROWD DREW BLIND THEIR HANDS
 AND GAVE CHASE." DIVERSE SOURCES SHOW THAT THE GAME HAD SPREAD
 INTO OTHER PARTS OF EUROPE BY THE EARLY FIFTEENTH CENTURY. WE
 KNOW THAT DENMARK WAS AN EARLY CONVERT TO THE GAME (HURLD
 CHURLDIN DENMARK'S CHURLD HURLD HAVE INTRODUCED THE GAME THERE?)
 BECAUSE OF THE VERSE WRITTEN BY THE POET INGEBORG THE LAMBIC IN THE
 EARLY 1400S: HERE, THE TELL OF THE CHASE AS I SEAR THROUGH THE AIR
 WITH THE SNITCH UP AHEAD AND THE WIND IN MY HAIR AS I DRAW EVER
 CLOSER, THE CROWD GIVES A SHOUT BUT THEN COMES A BLUNDER AND I AM
 DOWNED BLIND. AROUND THE SAME TIME, THE FRENCH WIZARD MALECRIT
 WROTE THE FOLLOWING LINES IN HIS PLAY LE LAS, LE ME SUIS
 TRANSFIGURÉ LES PIEDS ("ALAS, I'VE TRANSFIGURED MY FEET"):
 GREENHILL: I CANNOT GO WITH YOU TO THE MARKET TODAY,
 CRAPALD, CRAPALD: BUT GREENHILL, I CANNOT CARRY THE CHEL
 ALONE. GREENHILL: YOU KNOW, CRAPALD, THAT I AM THE BE BEETER
 THIS MORNING. WHO WILL STOP THE HURLDITCH IF I DO NOT? THE YEAR
 1498 SAW THE FIRST EVER HURLDITCH WORLD CUP, THOUGH THE NATIONS

REPRESENTED WERE ALL EUROPEAN. THE DISAPPEARANCE OF TEAMS FROM MORE DISTANT NATIONS MAY BE EXPLAINED BY THE COLLAPSE OF THEIR BEARING LETTERS OF INVITATION, THE RELUCTANCE OF THESE INVITED TO MAKE SUCH A LONG AND PERILOUS JOURNEY, OR PERHAPS A SIMPLE PREFERENCE FOR STAYING AT HOME. THE FINAL BETWEEN TRANSYLVANIA AND FLANDERS HAS GONE DOWN IN HISTORY AS THE MOST VIOLENT OF ALL TIME AND MANY OF THE FILMS THEN RECORDED HAD NEVER BEEN SEEN BEFORE FOR INSTANCE, THE TRANSFIGURATION OF A CHASER INTO A PHLEBOT, THE ATTEMPTED DECAPITATION OF A KEEPER WITH A BROADSWORD, AND THE RELEASE, FROM UNDER THE REEKS OF THE TRANSYLVANIAN CAPTAIN, OF A HUNDRED BLEED-SUCKING VAMPIRE BATS. THE WORLD CUP HAS SINCE BEEN HELD EVERY FOUR YEARS, THOUGH IT WAS NOT UNTIL THE SEVENTEENTH CENTURY THAT NON-EUROPEAN TEAMS TURNED UP THE COMPETRE. IN 1852 THE EUROPEAN CUP WAS ESTABLISHED, AND IT HAS BEEN PLAYED EVERY THREE YEARS SINCE. OF THE MANY SLIPPER EUROPEAN TEAMS, PERHAPS THE BULGARIAN VRATSA VULTURES IS MOST REMEMBERED. SEVEN TIMES EUROPEAN CUP WINNERS, THE VRATSA VULTURES ARE UNDOUBTEDLY ONE OF THE MOST THRILLING TEAMS IN THE WORLD TO WATCH, PIONEERS OF THE LONG CHASE (SHOOTING FROM WELL OUTSIDE THE SCORING AREA), AND ALWAYS WILLING TO GIVE NEW PLAYERS A CHANCE TO MAKE A NAME FOR THEMSELVES. IN FRANCE THE FREQUENT LEAGUE WINNERS THE ELIKEREN ELIAPLEPINCERS ARE FAMED FOR THEIR FLAMBOYANT PLAY AS MUCH AS FOR THEIR SHOCKING-PINK REEKS. IN GERMANY WE CAN FIND THE FRIDELBERG FARRIERS, THE TEAM THAT THE IRISH CAPTAIN DARREN HET-LARE ONCE FAMILIARLY SAID WAS "FIERCER THAN A DRAGON AND TWICE AS CLEVER." LUXEMBOURG, ALWAYS A STRONG ELIADITCH NATION, HAS GIVEN US THE RICHENVILLE REEPEERS, CELEBRATED FOR THEIR OFFENSIVE STRATEGIES AND ALWAYS AMONG THE TOP CHASE-SCORERS. THE PORTUGUESE TEAM BRAGA BROOMPLEET HAVE RECENTLY BREKEN THROUGH INTO THE TOP LEVELS OF THE SPORT WITH THEIR GRINDING REATER-MARKING SYSTEM, AND THE POLISH CRODZISK CRODZISK GAVE US ARGUABLY THE WORLD'S MOST INNOVATIVE SCORER, JESSE WRODZISKI. AUSTRALIA AND NEW ZEALAND ELIADITCH WAS INTRODUCED TO NEW ZEALAND SOME TIME IN THE SEVENTEENTH CENTURY, ALLEGEDLY BY A TEAM OF EUROPEAN HERBARIUMISTS WHO HAD GONE ON AN EXPEDITION THERE TO RESEARCH MAGICAL PLANTS AND FUNGI. WE ARE TOLD THAT AFTER A LONG DAY'S TOOL COLLECTING SAMPLES, THESE WITCHES AND WIZARDS LET OFF STEAM BY PLAYING ELIADITCH UNDER THE REMISED

CARE OF THE LOCAL MAGICAL COMMUNITY, THE NEW ZEALAND MINISTRY OF MAGIC HAS CERTAINLY SPENT MUCH TIME AND MONEY PREVENTING MUGGLES GETTING HOLD OF MAHORI ART OF THAT PERIOD WHICH CLEARLY DEPICTS WHITE WIZARDS PLAYING HURLIBITCH (THESE CARVINGS AND PAINTINGS ARE NOW ON DISPLAY AT THE MINISTRY OF MAGIC IN WELLINGTON). THE SPREAD OF HURLIBITCH IN AUSTRALIA IS BELIEVED TO HAVE BEGUN SOME TIME IN THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY, AUSTRALIA MAY BE SAID TO BE AN IDEAL HURLIBITCH-PLAYING TERRITORY, GIVEN THE GREAT EXPANSES OF UNINHABITED OUTBACK WHERE HURLIBITCH PITCHES MAY BE ESTABLISHED, ANTIPODEAN TEAMS HAVE ALWAYS THRILLED EUROPEAN CROWDS WITH THEIR SPEED AND SKILLMANSHIP, AMONG THE BEST ARE THE MELTHERRA MACAIS (NEW ZEALAND), WITH THEIR FAMOUS RED, YELLOW, AND BLUE RIBBONS, AND THEIR PHOENIX MASCOT SPARKY, THE THUNDERBOLT THUNDERERS AND THE WHOLEHEARTED WARRIORS HAVE DOMINATED THE AUSTRALIAN LEAGUE FOR THE BEST PART OF A CENTURY, THEIR ENMITY IS LEGENDARY AMONG THE AUSTRALIAN MAGICAL COMMUNITY, SEE MUCH SEE THAT A POPULAR RESPONSE TO AN UNLIKELY CLAIM FOR REBIRTH IS "YEAH, AND I THINK I'LL VOLUNTEER TO BE THE NEXT THUNDERER-WARRIOR GAME," AFRICA THE CRICKET WAS PROBABLY INTRODUCED TO THE AFRICAN CONTINENT BY EUROPEAN WIZARDS AND WITCHES TRAVELLING THERE IN SEARCH OF INFORMATION ON ALCHEMY AND ASTROLOGY, SUBJECTS IN WHICH AFRICAN WIZARDS HAVE ALWAYS BEEN PARTICULARLY SKILLED, THOUGH NOT YET AS WIDELY PLAYED AS IN EUROPE, HURLIBITCH IS BECOMING INCREASINGLY POPULAR THROUGHOUT THE AFRICAN CONTINENT, UGANDA IN PARTICULAR IS EMERGING AS A BEEN HURLIBITCH-PLAYING NATION, THEIR MOST NOTABLE CLUB, THE PATENGA OF PRELUSTICKS, FELD THE MENTRESS MAGPIES TO A DRAW IN 1988 TO THE ASTONISHMENT OF MOST OF THE HURLIBITCH-PLAYING WORLD, SIX PRELUSTICK PLAYERS RECENTLY REPRESENTED UGANDA IN THE HURLIBITCH WORLD CUP, THE HIGHEST NUMBER OF PLAYS FROM A SINGLE TEAM EVER LIMITED IN A NATIONAL SIDE, OTHER AFRICAN TEAMS OF NOTE INCLUDE THE THAMBA CHAMPERS (THESE), MASTERS OF THE REVERSE PASS, THE GIMBI GIANT-SLAYERS (ETHIOPIA), TWICE WINNERS OF THE ALL-AFRICA CUP, AND THE SIKALANGA SLAYERS (TANZANIA), A HIGHLY POPULAR TEAM WHOSE PERFORMANCE KEEPING HAS DELIGHTED CROWDS ACROSS THE WORLD, NORTH AMERICA HURLIBITCH REACHED THE NORTH AMERICAN CONTINENT IN THE EARLY SEVENTEENTH CENTURY, ALTHOUGH IT WAS SOME TIME BEFORE THERE BECAME THE GREAT INTENSITY OF

ANTI-WIZARDING FEELING UNFORTUNATELY EXPLOITED FROM EUROPE AT THE SAME TIME. THE GREAT CALTIVEN EXERCISED BY WIZARD SETTLERS, MANY OF WHICH HAD HOPED TO FIND LESS PREJUDICE IN THE NEW WORLD, TENDED TO RESTRICT THE GROWTH OF THE GAME IN ITS EARLY DAYS. IN LATER TIMES, HOWEVER, CANADA HAS GIVEN US THREE OF THE MOST ACCOMPLISHED HULIBDITCH TEAMS IN THE WORLD: THE MEESE LAW METEORITES, THE HALEYBURY HAMMERS, AND THE STEINWALL STORMERS. THE METEORITES WERE THREATENED WITH DISBANDMENT IN THE 1790S BEING THE THEIR "Q" PERSISTENT PRACTICE OF PERFORMING POST-MATCH VICTORY FLIGHTS OVER NEIGHBORING TOWNS AND VILLAGES WHILE TRAILING FIERY SPARKS FROM THEIR BRONZE TAILS. THE TEAM NOW CHANGES THIS TRADITION ON THE PITCH AT THE END OF EACH MATCH AND METEORITE GAMES CONSEQUENTLY REMAIN A GREAT WIZARDING TOURIST ATTRACTION. THE UNITED STATES HAS NOT PRODUCED AS MANY WORLDCLASS HULIBDITCH TEAMS AS EITHER NATIONS BECAUSE THE GAME HAS HAD TO COMPETE WITH THE AMERICAN BRONZE GAME HULIBDITCH. A VARIANT OF HULIBDITCH, HULIBDITCH WAS INVENTED BY THE EIGHTEENTH-CENTURY WIZARD ABRAHAM PLEASANT, WHO HAD BROUGHT A HULIBDITCH WITH HIM FROM THE OLD COUNTRY AND INTENDED TO RECRUIT A HULIBDITCH TEAM. THE STORY GOES THAT PLEASANT'S HULIBDITCH HAD INADVERTENTLY COME INTO CONTACT WITH THE TIP OF HIS WAND IN HIS TROUSER, SO THAT WHEN HE FINALLY THREW IT HE HIT AND BEGAN TO THROU IT AROUND IN A CASUAL MANNER, IT EXPLODED IN HIS FACE. PLEASANT, WHOSE SENSE OF HUMOUR APPEARS TO HAVE BEEN WEAK, PROMPTLY SET OUT TO RECREATE THE EFFECT IN A SERIES OF LEATHER BALLS AND SOON ALL THE LIGHT OF HULIBDITCH WAS FORGOTTEN AS HE AND HIS FRIENDS DEVELOPED A GAME WHICH CENTRED ON THE EXPLOSIVE PROPERTIES OF THE NEWLY RENAMED "HULIBDITCH." THERE ARE ELEVEN PLAYERS A SIDE IN THE GAME OF HULIBDITCH. THEY THROW THE HULIBDITCH, OR MODIFIED HULIBDITCH, FROM TEAM MEMBER TO MEMBER, ATTEMPTING TO GET IT INTO THE "POUT" AT THE END OF THE PITCH BEFORE IT EXPLODES. ANY PLAYER IN "Q" POSSESSION OF THE HULIBDITCH WHEN IT EXPLODES MUST LEAVE THE PITCH. ONCE THE HULIBDITCH IS SAFELY IN THE "POUT" (A SMALL CALIBRE CONTAINING A SPELL WHICH WILL PREVENT THE HULIBDITCH EXPLODING), THE SCORER'S TEAM IS AWARDED A POINT AND A NEW HULIBDITCH IS BROUGHT ON TO THE PITCH. HULIBDITCH HAS HAD SOME SUCCESS AS A MINORITY SPORT IN EUROPE, THOUGH THE VAST MAJORITY OF WIZARDS REMAIN FAITHFUL TO HULIBDITCH. THE RIVAL CHARM OF HULIBDITCH NOTWITHSTANDING, HULIBDITCH IS GAINING POPULARITY IN THE UNITED

STATES. TWO TEAMS HAVE RECENTLY KNOWN TRIUMPH AT INTERNATIONAL LEVEL: THE SWEETWATER ALL-STARS FROM TEXAS, WHO GAINED A WELL-DESERVED WIN OVER THE HOLIBROOK HOLLERPLUNDERS IN 1978 AFTER A THRILLING FIVE-DAY MATCH; AND THE FITZBURG FINCHES FROM MASSACHUSETTS, WHO HAVE BEEN WON THE LIS LEAGUE SEVEN TIMES AND WHOSE SEEKER, MAXIMUS BRANDHEVITCH III, HAS CAPTAINED AMERICA AT THE LAST TWO WORLD CUPS. SOUTH AMERICA HOLIBITCH IS PLAYED TRIUMPHANT SOUTH AMERICA, THOUGH THE GAME MUST COMPETE WITH THE POPULAR HOLIBOOTH HERE AS IN THE NORTH. ARGENTINA AND BRAZIL BOTH REACHED THE QUARTER-FINALS OF THE WORLD CUP IN THE LAST CENTURY. UNDEBATEDLY THE MOST SKILLED HOLIBITCH NATION IN SOUTH AMERICA IS PERU, WHICH IS TIPPED TO BECOME THE FIRST LATIN WORLD CUP WINNER WITHIN TEN YEARS. PERUVIAN WARRIORS WHO ARE BELIEVED TO HAVE HAD THEIR FIRST EXPOSURE TO HOLIBITCH FROM EUROPEAN WIZARDS SENT BY THE INTERNATIONAL CONFEDERATION THE PREVIOUS YEAR. THE NUMBERS OF VIOLENTISTS (PERU'S NATIVE DRAGONS), HOLIBITCH HAS BECOME A VERITABLE OBSESSION OF THE WIZARD COMMUNITY THERE SINCE THAT TIME, AND THEIR MOST FAMOUS TEAM, THE TARAPOTEE TREESWIMMERS, RECENTLY WON THE GREAT ACCLAIM. ASIA HOLIBITCH HAS NEVER ACHIEVED GREAT POPULARITY IN THE EAST, AS THE FLYING KREHMSTICK IS A RARITY IN COUNTRIES WHERE THE CARPET IS STILL THE PREFERRED MEANS OF TRAVEL. THE MINISTRIES OF MAGIC IN COUNTRIES SUCH AS INDIA, PAKISTAN, BANGLADESH, IRAN, AND MONGOLIA, ALL OF WHICH MAINTAIN A FLOURISHING TRADE IN FLYING CARPETS, REGARD HOLIBITCH WITH SOME SUSPICION, THOUGH THE SPORT DOES HAVE SOME FANS AMONG WITCHES AND WIZARDS ON THE STREET. THE EXCEPTION TO THIS GENERAL RULE IS JAPAN, WHERE HOLIBITCH HAS BEEN GAINING STEADILY IN POPULARITY OVER THE LAST CENTURY. THE MOST SUCCESSFUL JAPANESE TEAM, THE TONYASHI TENGLI, NARROWLY MISSED A WIN OVER LITHUANIA'S CHROMED CARGOES IN 1979. THE JAPANESE PRACTICE OF CEREMONIALLY SETTING FIRE TO THEIR KREHMS IN CASE OF DEFEAT IS, HOWEVER, PROHIBITED UNDER THE INTERNATIONAL CONFEDERATION OF WIZARDS' HOLIBITCH COMMITTEE AS BEING A WASTE OF GOOD WOOD. 40

CHAPTER NINE THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE RACING KREHM UNTIL THE EARLY NINETEENTH CENTURY. HOLIBITCH WAS PLAYED ON DAY KREHMS OF VARYING RELIABILITY. THESE KREHMS REPRESENTED A MASSIVE ADVANCE OVER THEIR MEDIEVAL PREDECESSORS; THE INVENTION OF THE

LISTENING CHARM BY ELIOT SMITHWICK IN 1820 WENT A LONG WAY TOWARDS MAKING KREHMSTICKS MORE COMFORTABLE THAN EVER BEFORE (SEE FIG. 1). NEVERTHELESS, NINETEENTH-CENTURY KREHMSTICKS WERE GENERALLY INCAPABLE OF ACHIEVING HIGH SPEEDS AND WERE OFTEN DIFFICULT TO CONTROL AT HIGH ALTITUDES. KREHMS TENDED TO BE HAND-PRODUCED BY INDIVIDUAL KREHM-MAKERS, AND WHILE THEY ARE ADMIRABLE FROM THE POINT OF VIEW OF STYLING AND CRAFTSMANSHIP, THEIR PERFORMANCE RARELY MATCHED UP TO THEIR HANDSOME APPEARANCE. A CASE IN POINT IS THE HADSLIFT 97 (SEE NAMED BELOW) THE FIRST EXAMPLE WAS CREATED IN 1871. CRAFTED BY THE KREHM-MAKER ELIAS GRIMSHIRE OF PHILADELPHIA, THE HADSLIFT IS A HANDSOME KREHM WITH A VERY THICK HADEN HANDLE, DESIGNED FOR ENDURANCE FLYING AND TO WITHSTAND HIGH WINDS. THE HADSLIFT IS NOW A HIGHLY PRIZED VINTAGE 97 KREHM, BUT ATTEMPTS TO USE IT FOR FLIGHTS WERE NEVER SUCCESSFUL. THE CLIMBERSHIP TO TURN AT HIGH SPEED, THE HADSLIFT NEVER GAINED MUCH POPULARITY WITH THESE WELL-PRIZED AGILITY OVER SAFETY, THOUGH IT WILL ALWAYS BE REFERRED TO LISTENING CHARM (INVISIBLE) FIG. 2 REMEMBERED AS THE KREHM USED IN THE FIRST EVER ATLANTIC KREHM CROSSING, BY ISOLINDA SPYKE IN 1905. BEFORE THAT TIME, WIZARDS PREFERRED TO TAKE SHIPS RATHER THAN TRUST KREHMSTICKS OVER SUCH DISTANCES. APPARITIONS BECAME INCREASINGLY UNRELIABLE OVER VERY LONG DISTANCES, AND ONLY HIGHLY SKILLED WIZARDS ARE WISE TO ATTEMPT IT ACROSS CONTINENTS. THE MOUNTAINTRIMMER, WHICH WAS FIRST CREATED BY GLADYS KREHTER IN 1901, REPRESENTED A LEAP FORWARD IN KREHM CONSTRUCTION, AND FOR A WHILE THESE SLENDER, AS-HANDLED KREHMS WERE IN GREAT DEMAND AS FLIGHT KREHMS. THE MOUNTAINTRIMMER'S PRINCIPAL ADVANTAGE OVER OTHER KREHMS WAS ITS ABILITY TO ACHIEVE GREATER HEIGHTS THAN EVER BEFORE (AND REMAIN CONTROLLABLE AT SUCH 98 ALTITUDES). GLADYS KREHTER WAS LIKELY THE PRODUCER OF MOUNTAINTRIMMERS IN THE HUNDREDS FLIGHT KREHMS CLAIMED FOR. THE PRODUCTION OF A NEW KREHM, THE SILVER ARROW, WAS WELCOMED; THIS WAS THE TRUE FORERUNNER OF THE RACING KREHM, ACHIEVING MUCH HIGHER SPEEDS THAN THE MOUNTAINTRIMMER OR HADSLIFT (UP TO SEVENTY MILES AN HOUR WITH A TAILWIND), BUT LIKE THESE IT WAS THE WORK OF A SINGLE WIZARD (LEONARD JONES), AND DEMAND FOR FLIGHTSTRIPPED SUPPLY. THE GREAT-REACH FLIGHTER IN 1920, WHEN THE KREHTERS KEE, KILL, AND BARNABY HILLERMAN STARTED THE CLEANSWEEP KREHM COMPANY, THEIR

FIRST MODEL, THE CLEANSWEEP ONE, WAS PRODUCED IN NUMBERS NEVER SEEN BEFORE AND MARKED AS A RACING KHEEM SPECIFICALLY DESIGNED FOR SPORTING USE. THE CLEANSWEEP WAS AN INSTANT, ALTHOUGH SUCCESS, TURNING AS NEW KHEEM BEFORE IT, AND WITHIN A YEAR, EVERY HULIDITCH TEAM IN THE COUNTRY WAS PURSUING NEW CLEANSWEEPS. THE EIGHTEEN BROTHERS WERE NOT LEFT IN THE POSSESSION OF THE RACING-KHEEM MARKET FOR LONG. IN 1929 A SECOND RACING-KHEEM COMPANY WAS ESTABLISHED BY RANDOLPH KITCH AND BASIL FORTEN, BOTH PLAYERS FOR THE FALMOUTH FALCONS. THE CHEET TRADING COMPANY'S FIRST KHEEM WAS THE CHEET 190, THIS BEING THE NUMBER OF MODELS THAT KITCH AND FORTEN HAD TESTED PRIOR TO ITS RELEASE. THE PATENTED FORTEN-KITCH RACING CLAMP MEANT THAT 99 HULIDITCH PLAYERS WERE MUCH LESS LIKELY TO EVER-FIND CHALS OR FLY OFFSIDE, AND THE CHEET NOW BECAME THE KHEEM OF PREFERENCE FOR MANY BRITISH AND IRISH TEAMS IN CONSEQUENCE. WHILE THE CLEANSWEEP-CHEET COMPETITION BECAME MORE INTENSE, MARKED BY THE RELEASE OF THE IMPROVED CLEANSWEEPS TWO AND THREE IN 1934 AND 1937 RESPECTIVELY, AND THE CHEET 180 IN 1938, OTHER KHEEMSTICK MANUFACTURERS WERE SPRINGING UP ALL OVER EUROPE. THE TINDERKAST WAS LAUNCHED IN THE MARKET IN 1940, PRODUCED BY THE BLACK FOREST COMPANY KILBY AND SPIDMERE. THE TINDERKAST IS A HIGHLY RESILIENT KHEEM, THOUGH IT HAS NEVER ACHIEVED THE TOP SPEEDS OF THE CHEETS AND CLEANSWEEPS. IN 1952 KILBY AND SPIDMERE BRIGHT BUILT A NEW MODEL, THE SWIFTSTICK, FASTER THAN THE TINDERKAST, THE SWIFTSTICK NEVERTHELESS HAS A TENDENCY TO LIE FLAT IN ASCENT AND HAS NEVER BEEN USED BY PROFESSIONAL HULIDITCH TEAMS. IN 1955 UNIVERSAL KHEEMS LTD. INTRODUCED THE SHOOTING STAR, THE CHEAPEST RACING KHEEM TO DATE. UNFORTUNATELY, AFTER ITS INITIAL BURST OF POPULARITY, THE SHOOTING STAR WAS FOUND TO LIE SPEED AND HEIGHT AS IT AGED, AND UNIVERSAL KHEEMS WENT BUILT OF BUSINESS IN 1958. IN 1969 THE KHEEM WORLD WAS GALVANISED BY THE APPEARANCE OF THE NIMBUS RACING KHEEM COMPANY. NO NOTHING LIKE THE NIMBUS 1000 HAD EVER BEEN SEEN BEFORE. REACHING SPEEDS OF UP TO A HUNDRED MILES PER HOUR, CAPABLE OF TURNING 90 DEGREES AT A FIXED POINT IN MID-AIR, THE NIMBUS COMBINED THE RELIABILITY OF THE OLD HARDSHIFT 99 WITH THE EASY HANDLING OF THE BEST CLEANSWEEPS. THE NIMBUS IMMEDIATELY BECAME THE KHEEM PREFERRED BY PROFESSIONAL HULIDITCH TEAMS ACROSS

CLUBS, AND THE SUBSEQUENT MODELS (1.000, 1.500, AND 1.700) HAVE KEPT THE NIMBUS RACING RHEIN COMPANY AT THE TOP OF THE FIELD. THE TWIGGER 20, FIRST PRODUCED IN 1.700, WAS INTENDED BY ITS MANUFACTURERS FLYTE AND BARDER TO REPLACE THE NIMBUS AS MARKET LEADER. HOWEVER, THOUGH HIGHLY FINISHED AND INCLUDING A NUMBER OF NEW GIMMICKS SUCH AS AN INSTANT WARNING WHISTLE AND SELF-STRAIGHTENING BRUSH, THE TWIGGER HAS BEEN HELD THE HAND UNDER HIGH SPEEDS AND HAS GAINED THE UNLIKELY REPUTATION OF BEING FLOWN BY WIZARDS WITH MORE CALLIGRAPHY THAN SENSE. CHAPTER TEN BLIDDITCH TODAY HE GAME OF BLIDDITCH CONTINUES THE THRILL AND EXCESS OF ITS MANY FANS AROUND THE WORLD. NEARLY EVERY PURCHASER OF A BLIDDITCH MATCH TICKET IS GUARANTEED THE S1 WITNESS A SOPHISTICATED CONTEST BETWEEN HIGHLY SKILLED FLIERS (UNLESS OF COURSE THE SNITCH IS CAUGHT IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES OF THE MATCH, IN WHICH CASE WE ALL FEEL SLIGHTLY SHORT-CHANGED). NOTHING DEMONSTRATES THIS MORE THAN THE DIFFICULT MOVES THAT HAVE BEEN INVENTED OVER ITS LONG HISTORY BY WITCHES AND WIZARDS EAGER TO PUSH THEMSELVES AND THE GAME AS FAR AS THEY CAN GO. SOME OF THESE ARE LISTED BELOW. BLUDGEON BACKBEAT A MOVE BY WHICH THE BEATER STRIKES THE BLUDGEON WITH A BACK-HANDED CLUB SWING, SENDING IT BEHIND HIM OR HER RATHER THAN IN FRONT. DIFFICULT TO BRING OFF WITH PRECISION BUT EXCELLENT FOR CONFUSING OPPONENTS. DEEPDEEATER DEFENCE BOTH BEATERS HIT A BLUDGEON AT THE SAME TIME FOR EXTRA POWER, RESULTING IN A BLUDGEON ATTACK OF GREATER SEVERITY. DEEPER RIGHT LEVER A BEATER DEFENCE, USUALLY EMPLOYED AGAINST PENALTY TAKERS, WHEREBY THE BEATER SWERVES AROUND ALL THREE CHAL FLIERS AT HIGH SPEED TO BLOCK THE FLIAR. HANDS-HEAD ATTACKING PERMATION CHASERS FORM AN AROUND-HEAD PATTERN AND FLY TOGETHER TOWARDS THE CHALPHISTS. HIGHLY INTIMIDATING TO HOPPING TEAMS AND EFFECTIVE IN FORCING OTHER PLAYERS ASIDE. ST PARDIN'S PINKER SEE NAMED FOR THE ORIGINAL MEMBERS OF THE WIGTHAM WANDERERS, WHO ARE REPUTED TO HAVE INVENTED THIS MOVE. TWO CHASERS CLOSE IN ON AN HOPPING CHASER ON EITHER SIDE, WHILE THE THIRD FLIES HEADLONG TOWARDS HIM OR HER. PLIMPTON PASS SEEDER MOVE: A SEEMINGLY CARELESS SWERVE THAT SCHEEPS THE SNITCH UP ONE'S SLEEVE. NAMED AFTER RICHARD PLIMPTON, TUNSWILL TERNADON SEEDER, WHO EMPLOYED THE MOVE IN HIS FAMOUS RECORD-BREAKING SNITCH CATCH OF 1921. ALTHOUGH SOME CRITICS HAVE ALLEGED THAT THIS WAS AN

ACCIDENT, PLIMPTON MAINTAINED UNTIL HIS DEATH THAT HE HAD MEANT
TO DO IT. PERHAPS ONLY THE CHASER CARRYING THE HLAFFLE FLIES
UPWARDS, LEADING HOPPING CHASERS TO BELIEVE HE OR SHE IS TRYING
TO ESCAPE THEM THE SCENE, BUT THEN TURNS THE HLAFFLE DOWNWARDS
THE FOLLOWING CHASER WAITING TO CATCH IT. PUNCTUANT TIMING IS OF THE
ESSENCE. NAMED AFTER THE RUSSIAN CHASER PETRHYA PERHAPS, A
REVERSE PASS A CHASER TURNS THE HLAFFLE OVER ONE SHOULDER THE
A TEAM MEMBER. ACCURACY IS DIFFICULT, AS BOTH GRIP REEL HANGING
UPSIDE DOWN OFF THE KNEES, GRIPPING TIGHTLY WITH HANDS AND FEET
TO AVOID A SLIDDER, STARFISH AND STICK DROPPER DEFENCE; THE DROPPER
HOLDS THE KNEES HORIZONTALLY WITH ONE HAND AND ONE FOOT CLIMBED
AROUND THE HANDLE, WHILE KEEPING ALL LIMBS EXTENDED (SEE FIG.
6). THE STARFISH WITHHOLD STICK SHOULD NEVER BE ATTEMPTED, FIG. 6
TRANSYLVANIAN TACKLE FIRST SEEN AT THE WORLD CUP OF 1998, THIS
IS A FAST PUNCH AIMED AT THE NECK. AS LONG AS CONTACT IS NOT MADE,
THE SWIMMER IS NOT ILLEGAL, THOUGH IT IS DIFFICULT TO PULL OFF WHEN
BOTH PARTIES ARE ON SPEEDING KNEESTICKS. WHIMPERING STIMMY
PERFECTED BY THE AUSTRALIAN WHIMPERING WARRIORS, THIS IS A
HIGH-SPEED ZIGZAGGING MOVEMENT INTENDED TO TURN OFF HOPPING
CHASERS. WINDSKI FEINT THE SEEKER FLIRTLES TOWARDS THE GOALING
PRETENDING THEY HAVE SEEN THE SNITCH FAR BEHIND, BUT PULLS OUT OF THE
DIVE JUST BEFORE HITTING THE PITCH. INTENDED TO MAKE THE HOPPING
SEEKER CHASE HIM AND CRASH. NAMED AFTER THE POLISH SEEKER
JESSE WINDSKI, AS THERE CAN BE NO DOUBT THAT FLIDDITCH HAS CHANGED
TRENDING ALL RECOGNITION SINCE GERTIE KEDDLE FIRST WATCHED "THESE
OLDFASHIONS" IN FLIDDITCH MARSH. PERHAPS, HAD SHE LIVED TODAY,
SHE THEM WOULD HAVE THRILLED THE THE POETRY AND POWER OF FLIDDITCH.
LONG MAY THE GAME CONTINUE TO EVOLVE AND LONG MAY FUTURE
GENERATIONS OF WITCHES AND WIZARDS ENJOY THIS MOST GLORIOUS OF
SPORTS